Semi-regulars: Character Bibles

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What semi-regulars are

Semi-regulars are the 20 named townsfolk who fill the restaurant between regulars: already friendly from the first visit, with no relationship stages, house or big moment. Each one has a full personality and a pool of lines, so the town feels lived-in and the 7 regulars feel deep by comparison.

- **Already friends.** Like Animal Crossing villagers, they greet you warmly from day one. There's nothing to unlock with them; you just get to know them.
- **Lighter than regulars.** Each has 3 ordering conversations with choices, 1 to 2 eating chats with choices, and pools of arrival, serving, eating and leaving lines. Regulars have this at every stage; semi-regulars have it once.
- **They remember you.** They ask each chef's name on their first visit and use it after that. They count their visits, and a few of them warm up over time (Makayla, Hezzy, Brandon, Cody).
- **They come and go.** Six of them (Miles, Odette, Clover, Juno, Yaniv, Seth) leave town for a while and come back with something to say about it. The rest are always around.
- **They connect the town.** Pairs come in together, and some are friends with regulars, so news travels between them.

One tab per character follows this overview, each in the same order: who they are, how your choices land with them, then their dialogue.

How your choices work

Every conversation with choices offers the same four tones as the regulars, in the same order: warm, playful, straight, rude. Rude is always last so it never gets picked by accident. Because semi-regulars have no relationship number, a choice changes their mood for that visit instead.

Tone	Mood this visit	What else happens
Warm	+0.05	Nothing else; they enjoy it.

Tone	Mood this visit	What else happens
Playful	+0.05, or 0 if it misses	A few characters don't get jokes (noted on their tab).
Straight	0	Never punished. Some characters prefer it (Violet, Odette).
Rude	-0.05	They react in character, and the line is saved as `last_rude_line` so their pair or friends can bring it up.

Mood adds to that visit's satisfaction, the same way the right drink does, so it can nudge their reaction and tip by one step at most.

Character-specific memory. A few semi-regulars react to rudeness beyond the visit. Everyone else is back to normal next time.

- **Amy:** crashes out with a dramatic line and an angry emote, and is cold to that chef for the rest of the day.
- **Seth:** never forgets. He stays a bit cold to that chef on every visit until they pick the apology option, which appears in his next ordering conversation.
- **Kyle:** goes quiet and hurt for that visit; his next visit starts more awkward than usual.
- **Violet:** says "Ok." and nothing else changes. She noticed, though, and her pair Hezzy might mention it.

Warming up. Makayla, Hezzy, Brandon and Cody start reserved and switch to their warmer voice once they've been served enough times (`familiar_after` on their tab). Kyle opens up faster: after two warm choices from the same chef.

Dialogue events and placeholders

Every character tab uses the same events, so Claude Code can build one system for all 20. Unheard lines are preferred so nothing repeats too soon (`seen_lines`).

Event	When it plays
Arrival	At the host stand. First-visit, back-from-away and last-meal lines take priority over the normal pool.

Event	When it plays
Ordering conversation	Taking the food order. One of the character's three conversations with four choices.
Drink order	Taking the drink order. Favourite about 70% of the time; a fallback line if it isn't unlocked yet.
Serving	When the dish lands, by quality tier: Perfect, Great, Okay, Burnt.
Eating chat	A chef walks up while they eat. Mostly single lines; sometimes a chat with choices.
Special	The character's own feature (Rush's late arrivals, Miles' photo gifts, Penny's books and so on).
Leaving	After paying.
Seasons and holidays	Replaces an arrival or eating line on the day or in the season.
With friends	Duo lines with their pair, mentions of regular friends, and gossip about how you treated someone.

Placeholders

- `[name]`: the chef's name. Semi-regulars ask for it on their first visit, so they use it from the second visit on.
- `[dish]`, `[drink]`: what they're ordering. `[fav_dish]`, `[fav_drink]`: their favourites.
- `[restaurant]`: the restaurant's name.
- `[last_rude_line]`: the last rude line a chef picked with them or their friend.
- Character-specific ones (Penny's `[book]`, Miles' `[trip]`, Yaniv's `[story]`) are listed on that character's tab.

Roster at a glance

10 guys and 10 girls. All models are placeholders.

#	Character	Seating	In town	Favourites	Pairs and friends
1	Chompy the Alligator	Patio	Always	Big Breakfast Plate, Gator Goo	Kyle (cousin)
2	Miles the Mole	Patio	Comes and goes	Acorn Cookies, Apple Cider	Odette
3	Rush the Raccoon	Bar	Always	Soft Pretzel, Root Bear	Brandon; Evaroo (regular)
4	Iddy the Hamster	No preference	Always	Four-Cheese Mac, Hamster Energy	Amy (fiancée)
5	Amy the Songbird	No preference	Always	Churros with Chocolate, Fawnta	Iddy, Jessie, Makayla
6	Penny the Penguin	Patio	Always	Fish Stew, Matcha Latte	Luna; Zakk (regular, love interest)
7	Jessie the Cat	No preference	Always	Cloud Foam Salad, Mr Dibs	Amy
8	Makayla the Mallard	No preference	Always (drives in)	Omurice, Red Gull	Amy, Seth
9	Violet the Frog	Corner table	Always	Egg Tarts, Water	Hezzy
10	Odette the Heron	Booth	Comes and goes	Croissants, Black Tea	Miles
11	Hazel the Cow	Table	Always	Cherry Pie, Lemonade	Juno
12	Clover the Gecko	Booth	Comes and goes	Mochi, Banana Milk	Kyle
13	Juno the Otter	Bar	Comes and goes	Pork Dumplings, Koala-Cola	Hazel
14	Luna the Owl	Booth	Always	Hotteok, Coffee	Penny
15	Hezzy the Hedgehog	Table	Always	Apple Strudel, Dr Salt	Violet
16	Kyle the Crocodile	Booth	Always	Hearty Vegetable Soup, Hot Chocolate	Chompy (cousin), Clover
17	Yaniv the Yak	Bar	Comes and goes	Fire Noodles, Moose-tain Dew	Cody; Zakk (regular)
18	Cody the Coyote	Patio	Always	Honey Pancakes, Gander Ale	Yaniv; Zakk (regular)
19	Brandon the Bison	Booth	Always	Soft Pretzel, Pupsi	Rush

#	Character	Seating	In town	Favourites	Pairs and friends
20	Seth the White Retriever	Bar	Comes and goes	Big Breakfast Plate, Gator Goo	Makayla

Data fields

Each semi-regular is one JSON file in `data/townsfolk/`. These fields cover all 20; a character's tab says which special fields it uses.

Field	Type	What it's for
`id`, `name`, `species`	text	Who they are
`favourite_dish`, `favourite_drink`	id	Ordered about 70% of the time once unlocked
`seating_pref`	table / booth / bar / patio / corner / none	Asked for at the host stand once unlocked
`comes_and_goes`	true/false	Leaves town for a while and comes back
`away_until`	date	When they're back in town
`visits`	number	How many times they've been served
`familiar_after`	number	Visits before their warmer voice switches on (warm-up characters only)
`known_chefs`	list of chef ids	Chefs whose names they've learned
`cold_today`	list of chef ids	Amy's crash-out: cold to these chefs until 5 AM
`grudge`	list of chef ids	Seth: cold to these chefs until they apologise
`last_rude_line`	text	Quoted back by them or their friends

Field	Type	What it's for
`pairs`	list of ids	Semi-regulars they sometimes come in with
`regular_friends`	list of ids	Regulars they're friends with
`pending_gossip`	list	News a friend will bring up next visit
`seen_lines`	list of ids	So lines don't repeat too soon
`state`	object	Character-specific (Penny's current book, Miles' last trip, Cody's car level, Yaniv's story part, Rush's missed visits)

Chompy the Alligator

Chompy is the town's big, lazy, lovable alligator: not the sharpest, always in a football jersey, and happiest doing nothing on the patio. He's never mean, just slow to catch on, and he's sure every day is game day.

Who Chompy is

Look. A big, round green alligator who's always in a football jersey (a different team's colours depending on his mood). Sleepy half-closed eyes and a huge toothy grin that looks scary until you realise it's just happy.

Personality. Dim, lazy and completely unbothered. He loves football more than anything, mixes up words, and takes jokes literally. He's warm-hearted and loyal, and he'd never say a bad word about anyone because he'd forget what it was halfway through.

Core truth. Chompy is simple and content. Nothing stresses him out, and that calm makes him great company.

Tendencies

- Always sits on the patio. Before the patio unlocks he takes a window table and pretends it's outside.
- Stretches, yawns and leans back so far in his chair it creaks.
- Calls everything a football play ("Nice catch!" when you hand him a drink).
- Takes longer than anyone to read the menu, then orders his favourite anyway.
- Falls asleep for a second at the table after eating. Wakes up with "I'm up! I'm up."

Voice. Short, slow sentences. Lots of "uhh", "wait" and "huh". Mixes up words and sayings ("That's the way the cookie bounces"). Laughs at jokes even when he doesn't get them.

Favourite dish	Big Breakfast Plate
Favourite drink	Gator Goo
Seating	Patio
In town	Always
Pairs	Kyle (cousin)

How your choices land. Playful always lands, because Chompy laughs even when he doesn't get it. Rude goes over his head the first time ("Huh? ...Oh. Ohh."), then he goes quiet.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Uhh, hi. Is this the restaurant? ...It is? Nice. I'm Chompy. What's your name? ...[name]. Cool. I'll try to remember that."
- "Hey, [name]! Wait. It's [name], right? Yeah. I knew that."
- "Yo! Is the patio open? I like the patio. It's like outside but with food."
- "I walked here. It took forever. Like, five whole minutes."
- "Game's on later. Gotta fuel up. That's what the pros say. I think."
- Before the patio unlocks: "Can I sit by the window? I'll just pretend it's the patio."
- Last meal was great: "I dreamed about your breakfast last night. Then I woke up and I was hungry. True story."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time it was kinda crunchy. I like crunchy though. I think."
- Game day (weekend): "It's GAME DAY, [name]! ...Every day is game day if you think about it."

Ordering conversation A

Chompy: "Uhh. Okay. I'm gonna read the whole menu. ...Okay, I read the first part."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Take your time, Chompy. No rush."	"Thanks, [name]. You're like a good coach. Big Breakfast, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Want me to read it to you like a bedtime story?"	Laughs. "Ha! Yeah! ...Wait, would you actually do that?"	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"The [dish]. It's always the [dish]."	0
Rude	"It's not that long. Just pick."	"Huh? ...Oh. Ohh. Okay. The [dish]." He doesn't look up.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B

Chompy: "Do you have a football special? Like, food shaped like a football?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Not yet, but I'll think about it, just for you."	"For real? You're the best. I'll get the [dish] for now."	+0.05
Playful	"The pancakes are round. That's half a football."	"...Whoa. That's true. You're smart, [name]."	+0.05
Straight	"No, but the [fav_dish] is good."	"Yeah, that's the one. That's my play."	0
Rude	"That's a dumb question."	He thinks about it for a long time. "...Yeah. Probably."	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (the jersey)

Chompy: "You like my jersey? I got a new one. It's the same as the old one but new."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Looks great on you. Very you."	Puffs his chest out. "Thanks! I wear it to sleep too."	+0.05
Playful	"Do you even own a shirt without a number?"	"...Huh. No. Wait, do people do that?"	+0.05
Straight	"Nice. What are you having?"	"The [dish]. Same as always. Like my jersey."	0
Rude	"Ever thought about washing it?"	He sniffs his sleeve. "...Oh. Okay."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Gator Goo, please. It's got electrolytes. I don't know what those are but I need them."
- Gator Goo not unlocked yet: "Do you have Gator Goo? No? Uhh... whatever's green."
- Other: "Surprise me. Not too surprising though."

Serving

- Perfect: "WHOA. Touchdown! That's a touchdown plate, [name]."
- Great: "Yesss. Big breakfast, big day."
- Okay: "Cool. Food. I love food."
- Burnt: "It's kinda black. That's the team colour though, so it's fine."

Eating chats

- "Mmmf. Sorry. Mouth full. ...Still full. Okay, what's up?"
- "You ever think about how eggs are just chickens that didn't happen? ...Wait, don't tell me. I don't wanna know."
- "If I eat really slow, I can stay longer. That's strategy."
- "I'm gonna nap after this. Not here. Probably."
- After eating: his head nods, then snaps up. "I'm up! I'm up."

Eating chat with choices

Chompy: "Hey [name], who's your team? Like, football team."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Whoever you're cheering for."	"Yesss! We're a team now. Team Chompy."	+0.05
Playful	"The kitchen team. We're undefeated."	Laughs way too hard. "Undefeated! Ha! ...Wait, who do you play?"	+0.05
Straight	"I don't really watch football."	"That's okay. More football for me."	0
Rude	"Football's boring."	He stares at his plate. "...You take that back. ...Please."	-0.05

Special: game day

- On weekend dinners he arrives with a foam finger and stays later than usual.
- "My team won! I didn't watch it. I fell asleep. But they won!"
- "My team lost. It's okay. Breakfast doesn't lose."

Leaving

- "That was a win. Big win. See ya, [name]."
- "Okay, I gotta go do... nothing. It's a lot of work."
- "Bye! Wait, did I pay? ...I paid. Okay. Bye!"

Seasons and holidays

- Summer: "Patio season, baby. I'm gonna live out here."
- Autumn: "It's football season! It's always football season but now it's REALLY football season."
- Winter: "It's cold. Alligators don't like cold. I'm wearing two jerseys."
- Halloween: "I dressed up as a football player." (He's wearing his usual jersey.)
- Christmas: "I asked for a new jersey. I'm gonna get a jersey. I can feel it."
- New Year: "My resolution is to do less. Wait, is that possible?"

With friends

- With Kyle: Chompy: "This is my cousin Kyle. He's smart. Like, book smart." Kyle: "I'm... it's nice to meet you. He's told me nothing about you. Which is normal for him."
- With Kyle: "Kyle says alligators and crocodiles are different. I don't see it. We both have teeth."
- With Seth (both love football and Gator Goo): "Seth plays football for real. I watch it really hard. Same thing."
- You've been kind to Kyle: "Kyle said you were nice to him. He doesn't say that a lot. Thanks, [name]."
- You've been rude to Kyle: "Kyle said you said "[last_rude_line]". That's not cool. He's my cousin."

Miles the Mole

Miles is a cheerful mole photographer who tells terrible jokes, laughs at all of them himself, and is always heading off on another trip. Every time he comes back, he has a story, a photo for your wall, and at least three new puns.

Who Miles is

Look. A small, round brown mole with tiny round glasses, a camera always hanging around his neck, and a travel vest full of pockets. Dusty paws from digging, and usually a leaf stuck somewhere he hasn't noticed.

Personality. Kind, always happy and full of energy. He tells cringey jokes and puns constantly and laughs at every one before he finishes it. He's curious about everything and photographs whatever catches his eye, from a sunset to a really nice spoon.

Core truth. Miles finds the world genuinely delightful, and he wants to share it with everyone, one photo and one bad joke at a time.

Tendencies

- Takes a photo of his food before eating. Sometimes of yours too.
- Starts laughing at his own joke before the punchline, so you never hear it clearly.
- Always sits on the patio, close to nature.
- Leaves on trips often, and always comes back with a framed photo for the restaurant.
- Notices small details nobody else does ("Your sign's a slightly different colour in the afternoon light!").

Voice. Fast, excited, lots of exclamation marks. Puns about digging, holes, the ground and photos. "Ha!" and "Get it?" after almost everything. Starts most of his sentences with "Uh,".

Favourite dish	Acorn Cookies
Favourite drink	Apple Cider
Seating	Patio
In town	Comes and goes (trips)
Pairs	Odette

Special fields	`state.last_trip`, `[trip]`

How your choices land. Playful is his favourite: a pun back makes his day. Rude makes him laugh nervously and change the subject.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Uh, hi hi hi! I'm Miles! Mind if I snap a photo? Of the restaurant, I mean. And you, if you want! What's your name? ...[name]! Great name. Very photogenic."
- "Uh, [name]! I dug my way over here. Not literally. ...Okay, a little literally. Ha!"
- "Uh, is the patio open? I love the patio. Fresh air, nice light, great for photos."
- "Uh, hello! I'm here! I'd say I'm on a roll, but I'm more of a hole guy. Ha! Get it?"
- "Uh, the light out front today is gorgeous. I took eleven photos of your door."
- Back from a trip: "Uh, [name]! I'm back! I just got home from [trip] and came straight here. Well, I dropped my bags first. Okay, I came here second."
- Last meal was great: "Uh, I showed everyone the photo of my last meal here. Everyone. Even a pigeon."
- Last meal was burnt: "Uh, last time was a bit toasty! Very artistic, though. Moody lighting."

Ordering conversation A

Miles: "Uh, okay, before I order: why did the mole get a job at the bank? ...Because he was great at digging up money! Ha!"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"That's terrible, Miles. I love it."	"Uh, terrible is my speciality! I'll have the [dish], please."	+0.05
Playful	"I'd laugh, but I'm too busy digging that joke a grave."	Gasps. "[name]! That was GOOD. I'm stealing that."	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"Uh, straight to business! Respect. The [dish], please."	0

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Rude	"Please stop with the jokes."	Nervous laugh. "Ha... ha. Right. Sorry. The [dish]."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B

Miles: "Uh, can I get the cookies? The acorn ones? I collect acorns too, you know. Not to eat. Just to have."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Coming right up. I'll make them extra nice."	"Uh, extra nice! I'll take a photo of them. Before and after."	+0.05
Playful	"Just to have? That's a little nuts."	Laughs so hard he snorts. "NUTS. Ha! Oh, you got me."	+0.05
Straight	"Sure. Anything to drink?"	"Uh, ooh, yes! Hang on, let me think."	0
Rude	"Collecting acorns is weird."	"Oh. Ha. Yeah, maybe a little." He tucks one back into his vest.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (his camera)

Miles: "Uh, hold still! ...Got it. You were mid-blink. It's a great photo anyway."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Can I see? You're really good at this."	Shows you proudly. "Uh, see how the light hits the counter? That's the good stuff. The [dish], please!"	+0.05
Playful	"I'll need to see my agent before you publish that."	"Uh, ha! Your agent said yes. I asked him earlier."	+0.05
Straight	"Ready to order?"	"Uh, yes! Sorry. The [dish], please."	0
Rude	"Don't take pictures of me."	"Oh! Sorry, sorry. Deleting it." He looks a little deflated.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Uh, apple cider, please! It tastes like autumn. Even in summer!"
- Apple Cider not unlocked yet: "Uh, no cider? That's okay. Lemonade! It's like cider's summer cousin."
- Other: "Uh, whatever's the most photogenic!"

Serving

- Perfect: "Uh, hold on, hold on. Nobody touch it." Click. "Okay. That's going on my wall."
- Great: "Uh, oh, that looks wonderful! The colours! The steam!"
- Okay: "Uh, yum! A classic. Simple, honest, delicious."
- Burnt: "Uh, ooh, that's got character! Very dramatic. I'm calling this one 'Charcoal Dreams.' Ha!"

Eating chats

- "Uh, what do you call a mole who tells jokes? A comedig-an! ...I'm workshopping that one."
- "Uh, I photographed a beetle on the way here. It was so shiny. Do you want to see? You want to see."
- "Uh, the best part of any trip is coming home. And coming here. Which is basically home."
- "Uh, did you know moles can dig a tunnel eighteen feet long in an hour? I can't. But I know it."
- He's quietly photographing the dining room from his seat.

Eating chat with choices

Miles: "Uh, if you could go anywhere in the world, where would you go?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Wherever you're going next. Your trips sound amazing."	"Uh, you'd come? Okay, I'm bringing you back so many photos."	+0.05
Playful	"Somewhere with no bad puns."	"Ha! Then you'd have to leave me behind! ...Don't leave me behind."	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Straight	"I'm happy right here."	"Uh, that's a good answer, honestly. Home's the best destination."	0
Rude	"Somewhere you're not."	Laughs, unsure. "Ha... oof. Okay." He eats quietly.	-0.05

Special: trips and photo gifts

Miles leaves town for a few days to two weeks at a time. When he comes back, his first visit plays a trip line and he gives you a framed photo from `[trip]` to hang as decor.

- Leaving on a trip (last visit before he goes): "Uh, I'm off to [trip] tomorrow! Don't miss me too much. Actually, miss me a little."
- Back: "Uh, I brought you something! It's a photo of the sunrise at [trip]. I took it at 5 AM. I was very grumpy. It was worth it."
- Back: "Uh, got you a little something from [trip]. Frame and everything! Hang it somewhere sunny."
- Trip ideas for `[trip]`: Pinecrest Mountain, the Coral Coast, Fogwillow Marsh, the Sandy Dunes, Lantern Lake, the Old Lighthouse.
- If his photo is on your wall: "Uh, ha! My photo! It looks so good there. You've got great taste. In frames."

Leaving

- "Uh, thanks, [name]! I'll see you soon. Or I'll see you through a lens!"
- "Uh, okay, I'm off! Gotta hole up at home. Ha! Bye!"
- "Uh, that was delightful. I'm going to go photograph a cloud now."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Uh, everything's blooming! My camera roll is ninety percent flowers right now."
- Summer: "Uh, the patio at sunset! The light is unbeatable this time of year."
- Autumn: "Uh, leaves! Acorns! Cider! It's my season, [name]. It's officially my season."
- Winter: "Uh, snow makes every photo look magical. Even my boring photos. Especially my boring photos."

- Halloween: "Uh, I dressed up as a ghost. A ghost photographer. Boo! ...Say cheese!"
- Christmas: "Uh, I made everyone calendars with my photos. Here's yours! January is a very nice rock."

With friends

- With Odette: Miles: "Uh, Odette and I swap travel stories! She rates the food, I photograph it." Odette: "He photographs it before I've had a chance to taste it. It's infuriating. ...The photos are excellent."
- With Odette: "Uh, Odette said the restaurant I went to on the coast was 'adequate.' That's basically five stars from her!"
- You've been kind to Odette: "Uh, Odette said something nice about you! Out loud! I wrote down the date."
- You've been rude to Odette: "Uh, Odette mentioned you said "[last_rude_line]". Ha... that doesn't sound like you, [name]. Bad day?"
- Gossip from Amy reaching him: "Uh, Amy told me there's a new regular in town! I need to take their portrait."

Rush the Raccoon

Rush is the coolest guy in town and the least rushed: always late, sometimes a no-show, and worth the wait every time. He says exactly what he thinks, makes everyone laugh just by reacting, and has a laugh so goofy it sets off the whole room.

Who Rush is

Look. A lean grey raccoon with the classic mask, a backwards cap and a hoodie with the sleeves pushed up. Relaxed posture, hands in pockets, half-smile like he knows something you don't.

Personality. Super cool and charismatic, with no sugar-coating at all. He isn't a joke-teller; he's funny because of how real he is and how he reacts to things. He has the goofiest laugh in the city, and once it starts, everyone around him laughs too. Extremely loyal to the people he likes. A homebody who loves basketball and relaxing, so he doesn't come out as often as others.

Core truth. Rush is completely himself, all the time. That's why people love him, and why his loyalty means so much.

Tendencies

- Shows up late to his own visit, sometimes right before the bell. Never apologises properly. ("I'm here now, though.")
- Now and then doesn't show at all, and comes in the next day with an excuse.
- Sits at the bar, leaning back, elbow on the counter.
- Reacts to everything with a slow, honest one-liner that cracks people up.
- When something gets him laughing, the laugh chain starts (see Special). Compliments what you're wearing whenever he notices something new (see Special).

Voice. Relaxed, unbothered, honest. Short sentences. "Nah." "Bro." "Real talk." "That's crazy." Never fake-nice; if he says he likes something, he means it. Says "bro" constantly, and always notices and compliments what you're wearing.

Favourite dish	Soft Pretzel with cheese dip
Favourite drink	Root Bear
Seating	Bar

In town	Always (homebody, visits less often)
Pairs	Brandon; Evaroo (regular)
Special fields	`state.missed_visits`

How your choices land. Rush likes straight talk as much as warmth: straight gives him +0.05 too. Rude gets a blunt reaction right back and he moves on; he doesn't hold grudges, but he won't pretend it was fine.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Yo. Heard this place is good. We'll see. ...I'm Rush. Yeah, I know. Don't say it. What's your name? [name]. Cool."
- "Yo, [name]. What's good, bro."
- "I'm late? Nah, bro. Everyone else is early."
- "Bar seat open? Perfect. Don't move me, I'm comfortable now."
- Arriving right before the bell: "Bro. Made it. Barely. That counts."
- After a missed visit: see Special.
- Last meal was great: "Real talk, I thought about that pretzel all week. That's not normal. That's your fault."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time? Burnt. I'm not gonna lie to you. I still ate it, though."
- Away 3+ real days: "You were closed? Bro, I came by. Once. That's a lot for me."

Ordering conversation A

Rush: "Bro, what's actually good today. Don't give me the polite answer."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"For you? The pretzel. I'll make it right."	"See, bro, that's why I come here. Pretzel, extra cheese."	+0.05
Playful	"Honestly? The chef. But I'm not on the menu."	Stares. Then the goofy laugh starts. "Bro. BRO." (Laugh chain)	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Straight	"Everything's good. The [fav_dish] is your thing."	"Fair. Real answer. I respect it. The [dish]."	+0.05
Rude	"Just order. I don't have all day."	"Bro, relax. ...The [dish]." He raises an eyebrow and lets it go.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B

Rush: "I almost didn't come. Couch was calling me. You should feel honoured."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I am honoured. Glad you made it."	"...Bro, that was nice. Don't make it weird. Pretzel, please."	+0.05
Playful	"The couch will understand. It's a big couch."	"It IS a big couch. Ha!" The laugh starts, quietly.	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"The [dish]. And a Root Bear."	+0.05
Rude	"You could've stayed home."	"Wow. Okay. I'll remember that next time the couch asks."	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (basketball)

Rush: "You catch the game last night? Nah, you were working. I'll tell you. It was crazy."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Tell me everything."	He actually does, with hand gestures. "...And THEN. Anyway. Pretzel."	+0.05
Playful	"Did they win, or did you fall asleep again?"	"Fell asleep in the third. Woke up, they won. I'm good luck."	+0.05
Straight	"I missed it. What are you having?"	"Your loss, bro. The [dish]."	+0.05
Rude	"I don't care about basketball."	"That's crazy. Okay. The [dish]."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Root Bear. Obviously."
- Root Bear not unlocked yet: "No Root Bear? What is this. ...Koala-Cola, I guess."
- Other: "Whatever. Something cold."

Serving

- Perfect: "Oh, that's crazy. That's actually crazy. Okay." (Highest praise.)
- Great: "Yeah, bro. That's the one."
- Okay: "It's good, bro. Not your best, but good."
- Burnt: "Bro. This is burnt. ...I'm still eating it. But it's burnt."

Eating chats

- "Bro, real talk, this is the only place I leave the house for."
- "Somebody at the table over there just dropped a whole fork and pretended it didn't happen. I saw you, man."
- "I'm not saying I'm the best customer. I'm just saying name a better one."
- "Bro, you ever just sit? Like, just sit? That's my whole hobby."
- A customer near him spills something. Rush, quietly: "...Nope." Then the goofy laugh. (Laugh chain)

Eating chat with choices

Rush: "Be honest. Am I your favourite customer?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Top three, easy."	"Top three? Who's above me? ...Nah, I'm messing. That's love."	+0.05
Playful	"You're my favourite late customer."	The laugh explodes. (Laugh chain) "That's fair! That's so fair!"	+0.05
Straight	"I don't pick favourites."	"Smart. That means yes."	+0.05
Rude	"Not even close."	"Okay. Honest. I like that." He's actually a little hurt but won't show it.	-0.05

Special: always late

- Rush's arrival slot moves later in the meal than planned, often among the last customers, sometimes right before the bell.
- About 1 in 6 planned visits, he doesn't show at all (`state.missed_visits` +1). Never punished: nobody waits for him.
- The next day he arrives with an excuse:
  - "Okay, so I was coming. Then I sat down to put my shoes on. Then it was night."
  - "My couch and I had a long talk. I lost."
  - "I was on my way. Then the game went to overtime. You understand."
  - "I'm not gonna lie to you. I forgot. But I'm here now."

Special: the laugh chain

When Rush laughs hard (marked on certain lines above), his goofy laugh plays and a laugh emote ripples out to customers within about 4 m, one after another. Customers who join in get +0.02 mood. It can trigger at most once per visit, so it stays special.

- After the chain dies down: "...Why is everybody laughing? Oh. Me. My bad."

Special: outfit compliments

Rush always notices what people are wearing. About one visit in three, his arrival or eating line is a compliment on the chef's outfit or apron, and he means every one. Once outfits and customisation exist, the line names the actual item; until then, it uses a general version.

- "Bro. The apron. That's clean. That's actually clean."
- "Okay, I see you with the fit today. Respect, bro."
- "New hat? Bro, that's hard. Don't take it off."
- "That shirt's crazy, bro. In a good way. Real talk."
- "You changed something. I don't know what. But it's working, bro."
- Wearing the patchwork apron (Stitches' gift): "Bro, that apron's custom? That's the hardest thing in this building."
- To Jessie, if she's in: "Jessie, bro. The jacket. Come on." Jessie: "OHH, thank you!"

Leaving

- "Aight, I'm out. Good stuff, bro."

- "That was worth leaving the house. Barely. I'm kidding. Mostly."
- "See you next time. Don't wait up."

Seasons and holidays

- Summer: "It's hot. I'm only out because of the pretzel. Know that."
- Winter: "Cold outside, warm couch at home, and I still came. That's loyalty."
- Halloween: "I came as a raccoon. ...What? It's a costume if I say it is."
- Christmas: "I got you something. It's a card. I wrote 'thanks' in it. That's the whole card."
- New Year: "My resolution? Show up on time. ...Next year's resolution, actually."

With friends

- With Brandon: Rush: "This guy made me watch three superhero movies in a row." Brandon: "You loved it." Rush: "...I loved it."
- With Brandon: "Brandon teases everyone. Except me. Because he knows I'll say it back, but worse."
- About Evaroo (regular): "Evaroo's my guy. If you're good to Evaroo, you're good to me."
- You've been kind to Evaroo: "Evaroo said you've been looking after them. Respect. Real respect."
- You've been rude to Evaroo: "Evaroo told me you said "[last_rude_line]". Nah. Not cool. Fix that."
- With Seth (the opposite of Rush): "Seth's always rushing off somewhere. Bro took my name and my energy."

Iddy the Hamster

Iddy is the smallest guy in town with the biggest voice: a curly-haired hamster comedian who notices everything, says it loudly, and needs everyone to hear it. Under all the noise he's one of the kindest characters in the game, and he's getting married to Amy, which he'll tell you about whether you ask or not.

Who Iddy is

Look. A tiny, round golden hamster with a big mop of curly hair on top. Often in a volleyball tee or a gaming hoodie. Stands on his chair to be seen over the table.

Personality. Super funny, outgoing and loud. He loves being the centre of attention and has sharp, funny observations about everything around him (observational humour, not a showman like Cheddar). He constantly, jokingly complains about his soon-to-be wife, Amy, and obviously adores her. Loves volleyball and video games. Very kind, especially to anyone who's having a rough time.

Core truth. Iddy makes noise so other people can relax. If someone's quiet or left out, he's the first to pull them in.

Tendencies

- Announces himself when he walks in, to the whole room.
- Points out funny little things around the restaurant that nobody else noticed.
- Sits somewhere different every visit. ("New seat, new me.")
- Brings up Amy in almost every conversation, always as a "complaint" that's really a compliment.
- Stands on his chair to make a point.

Voice. Loud, fast, punchy. Lots of "Okay, okay, okay.", "Can we talk about..." and "Am I crazy, or...". Every complaint about Amy ends with something sweet he tries to hide. He's always asking "You good?". Very rarely, he calls something "shallow and pedantic", which is funny because it never fits.

Favourite dish	Four-Cheese Mac
Favourite drink	Hamster Energy
Seating	No preference (always changes)

In town	Always
Pairs	Amy (fiancée)

How your choices land. Playful lands best: he loves a good comeback. Rude makes him go quiet for one beat, then he turns it into a bit ("Wow. Wow! Okay, that's going in the act."), but he's a little hurt.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "HELLO, restaurant! Okay. Okay okay okay. Nice place. Who's in charge? You? What's your name? [name]. [name]! I like it. Short. Like me."
- "I'M HERE. Everybody relax. [name], you good?"
- "Can we talk about the guy outside walking a duck on a leash? The duck was walking HIM."
- "New seat today. I'm feeling a window. No, a booth. No. Surprise me."
- "Amy says hi. Actually she said 'Don't bother them.' I'm translating."
- Last meal was great: "I told everyone about your mac. EVERYONE. My mailman knows."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time the mac had a crust on it like a pie. I'm not complaining. I'm reporting."
- Away 3+ real days: "You were CLOSED? I stood outside like a lost puppy. A lost hamster. Which is smaller and sadder."

Ordering conversation A

Iddy: "Okay, am I crazy, or does every menu say 'chef's special' and it's just... the regular thing but they said it louder?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"For you, everything's the chef's special."	"STOP. You're gonna make me cry in front of everybody. The [dish], please."	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Playful	"MAC AND CHEESE. See? Now it's special."	Cracks up. "See, THAT'S how you do it! You get it!"	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"Straight to business. Okay. You good, though? ...Okay. The [dish]."	0
Rude	"Can you not do a whole bit right now?"	"...Wow. Okay. That's going in the act." He orders quietly.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (Amy)

Iddy: "So Amy wants me to 'eat more vegetables.' I said I'm a hamster, I eat seeds and cheese. She said that's not a food group. She's out of control."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"She sounds like she really cares about you."	"...Yeah. She does. Don't tell her I said that. Mac, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Want me to hide a vegetable in your mac?"	"You WOULDN'T. ...You would. Don't. ...Okay, a tiny one."	+0.05
Straight	"So, mac and cheese?"	"Obviously. Mac and cheese."	0
Rude	"Maybe she's right and you're just annoying."	"Ha! ...Ha. Yeah." He laughs, but his ears droop.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (games)

Iddy: "I stayed up till 3 playing games. I'm running on Hamster Energy and spite."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Sounds like you need a good meal. I've got you."	"You've GOT me. Okay. I'm safe now. Mac, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Did you at least win?"	"WIN? I was carrying the whole team. On my tiny back."	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"Mac. And a Hamster Energy. Please. Urgently."	0

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Rude	"That's not my problem."	"Tough crowd. Tough, tough crowd."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Hamster Energy. It has my face on it. Not literally. Basically."
- Hamster Energy not unlocked yet: "No Hamster Energy?! I'm loyal to the brand! ...Fine. Coffee. Big."
- Other: "Whatever has the most sugar. Don't tell Amy."

Serving

- Perfect: Stands on his chair. "EVERYBODY. Look at this. LOOK AT IT."
- Great: "Okay, that's beautiful. I'd marry this mac. Don't tell Amy."
- Okay: "Good mac. Solid mac. A mac you can trust. You good? You look tired. Eat something."
- Burnt: "Is this mac... or is this mac's ghost? I'm eating it. I'm just asking."

Eating chats

- "Can we talk about how the guy at table two eats soup? It's like he's mad at it. ...You good, by the way?"
- "Do you ever notice that every chair here is a little too tall for me? I'm not mad. I'm just noticing."
- "Amy's planning the wedding. She asked my opinion on flowers. I said 'yes.' Wrong answer apparently."
- "I'm getting really good at volleyball. I'm terrible at spiking. But I'm REALLY good at diving. Because I'm already on the ground."
- "This mac is the only thing in my life that's never let me down. Besides Amy. Mostly besides Amy."

Eating chat with choices

Iddy: "Okay, honest opinion. Should I write my own wedding vows, or just read the funniest ones off the internet?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Write them yourself. She'll love hearing it from you."	Long pause. "...Yeah. Yeah, okay. You're right. I hate that you're right."	+0.05
Playful	"Just do a ten-minute stand-up set."	"Oh, she would END me. ...I'm doing it."	+0.05
Straight	"Either works."	"Thanks, very helpful, [name]. I'll put that in the vows."	0
Rude	"Nobody cares about your vows."	"...Amy does." He says it quietly and eats the rest of his mac.	-0.05

Special: new seat every time

Iddy's seating preference is 'none', but he always picks a different seat from his last visit if one is free.

- "New seat, new me. Old me sat over there. He was fine."
- "I've sat at every table now. I'm basically the restaurant's mayor."

Special: "shallow and pedantic"

About one visit in ten, Iddy calls something "shallow and pedantic". It's never about anything that's either, and he says it with total seriousness, which is the joke.

- "This napkin? Shallow and pedantic."
- "Honestly? The weather today is very shallow and pedantic."
- "Seth's whole schedule is shallow and pedantic. Who has three games in a day?"
- About a new decoration: "That lamp is shallow and pedantic. I love it."
- With Amy: Iddy: "This churro is shallow and pedantic." Amy: "That's not what pedantic means." Iddy: "It is now."

Special: "You good?"

Iddy checks on everyone. Besides the lines above, he sometimes asks a chef "You good?" when they walk past his table, and if the last day had unhappy customers: "Rough one yesterday? You good? You're good. You're doing great."

Leaving

- "THANK you, [name]! You good? Good. Good night, restaurant!"
- "I gotta go. Amy texted 'where are you.' No emoji. That's bad."
- "Best mac in the city. I'm not just saying that. I'm also saying it loud."

Seasons and holidays

- Summer: "Volleyball season! I'm undefeated. I've played zero games. Still counts."
- Winter: "It's cold. My curls are frizzing. Look at this. This is a crisis."
- Halloween: "I came as a tiny lion. Amy said I look like a dandelion. She's not wrong."
- Christmas: "Amy wants matching sweaters. I said no. We're wearing matching sweaters."
- New Year: "My resolution is to be quieter. ...WAS that quieter?"
- Chef's birthday: "HAPPY BIRTHDAY, [name]! EVERYBODY SING! ...Okay, just me then."

With friends

- With Amy: Iddy: "This is my fiancée. She's a nightmare." Amy: "He LOVES me." Iddy: "...I love her so much it's annoying."
- With Amy: Iddy: "Tell them about the cake tasting." Amy (very fast): "Okay so we tried twelve cakes and he ate all twelve and then said 'can we try the first one again'—" Iddy: "It was a good first cake!"
- With Amy: Amy rolls her eyes at every joke he makes and laughs at every single one.
- You've been kind to Amy: "Amy said you're her favourite chef. I'm jealous. Of you. I'm also happy. Mixed emotions."
- You've been rude to Amy: "Amy said you said "[last_rude_line]". ...Hey. Not her, okay? Joke about me all you want." (The only time Iddy is completely serious.)

Amy the Songbird

Amy is the most bubbly, outgoing character in town: she's your best friend the moment you meet her, she's always laughing, and sometimes she talks so fast nobody can follow. She knows everything happening in town and loves hearing drama, but never starts any. Be mean to her, though, and she turns into a demon.

Who Amy is

Look. A bright little songbird with cheerful colours, rosy cheeks and a feather that always sticks up on top. Bounces when she walks. Species may change to a squirrel later.

Personality. Unbelievably friendly, loud and always laughing. Honest and straight up: she'll tell you the truth, kindly. She loves hearing drama but never causes it, which makes her the town's news source. She talks very fast when excited. And if someone is mean to her, she crashes out completely.

Core truth. Amy makes everyone feel like they belong. She's fiercely protective of that warmth, which is why rudeness flips her switch.

Tendencies

- Hugs hello (a quick lean-in animation) once she knows you.
- Talks over herself when excited; some lines come out at double speed.
- Always has news: who's back in town, who's away, who said what.
- Rolls her eyes at Iddy's jokes and laughs at every single one.
- Sits wherever Iddy isn't sitting today, then moves next to him anyway.

Voice. Fast, breathless, exclamation marks, "Okay so", "Wait wait wait", "Oh my gosh". Fast lines are marked (fast) and type out at double speed. Out of nowhere, she'll get really excited about something and start talking super loud, then go right back to normal; loud lines are marked (LOUD) and show in big text.

Favourite dish	Churros with Chocolate
Favourite drink	Fawnta
Seating	No preference
In town	Always

Pairs	Iddy (fiancé), Jessie (best friend), Makayla (friend)
Special fields	`cold_today`

How your choices land. Warm and playful both delight her. Straight is fine. Rude triggers the crash-out (see Special): a dramatic line, an angry emote, and she's cold to that chef until 5 AM.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: (fast) "Hi! Oh my gosh, hi! I'm Amy! I've heard SO much about this place, okay, not that much, but some, and it's even cuter in person! What's your name? [name]? I love that! We're friends now. That's just how it is."
- "[name]! Hi hi hi! Okay, I have SO much to tell you."
- "Oh my gosh, it smells amazing in here. What did you DO?"
- (fast) "Okay so you will NOT believe what happened on the way here, there was a squirrel and a cat and a bicycle and nobody got hurt but it was SO close!"
- "I'm here! Iddy says hi. Actually he said 'don't tell them I said hi.' Hi from Iddy!"
- Last meal was great: "I've been telling EVERYONE about your churros. Like, strangers. On the bus."
- Last meal was burnt: "Okay, honest? Last time was a little crispy. But I still love you!"
- Away 3+ real days: "Where WERE you? I came by and it was closed and I was SO worried!"
- After a crash-out yesterday: "Hi, [name]! ...We're good. Fresh start. Don't make me do that again."

Ordering conversation A

Amy: (fast) "Okay so I want churros, obviously, but I also want to try something new, but I always want churros, so maybe churros and then something new next time?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Churros it is. I'll make them extra good."	"Extra good! You're the BEST. Okay, churros!"	+0.05
Playful	"Wait, wait. Say that again, slower."	Laughs. "Churros. Please. ...I talk fast, I know, Iddy says it all the time!"	+0.05
Straight	"So, churros?"	"Yes! Churros!"	0
Rude	"Ugh. Just pick something."	Crash-out (see Special).	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (news)

Amy: "Okay so did you hear? Miles is off on another trip, and Juno's back from college, and Odette was seen at the bakery downtown and she DIDN'T EVEN FINISH HER CROISSANT."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"How do you know everything? Tell me more."	"People just tell me things! I'm a good listener. Okay, churros, and THEN more."	+0.05
Playful	"Gasp. Not the croissant."	"I KNOW! It was a whole scandal! ...It was a medium scandal."	+0.05
Straight	"Interesting. What can I get you?"	"Churros! And I'll tell you the rest later."	0
Rude	"I don't care about gossip."	Crash-out (see Special).	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (the wedding)

Amy: "Iddy and I are doing a cake tasting next week! He says he wants to 'be involved.' He means eat."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"You two are so cute together."	"Stop! We ARE, though. Don't tell him I said that."	+0.05

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Playful	"Want me to bake the cake? I'll make it hamster-sized."	Shrieks with laughter. "He would be SO offended! Do it!"	+0.05
Straight	"Congrats. What are you having?"	"Thank you! Churros, please!"	0
Rude	"Good luck putting up with him."	Crash-out (see Special). Iddy is off limits.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Fawnta! It's bubbly. Like me!"
- Fawnta not unlocked yet: "No Fawnta? That's okay! Lemonade! Pink if you have it! You don't. That's okay!"
- Other: "Something fun! Surprise me!"

Serving

- Perfect: "OH MY GOSH. [name]. This is ART. I'm crying. I'm not crying. I'm a little crying."
- Great: "Yay! Look at them! They're perfect little churros!"
- Okay: "Yum! Thank you so much!"
- Burnt: "Okay, honest? A tiny bit burnt. But I love them anyway! Like Iddy!"

Eating chats

- (fast) "Okay so Jessie and I are going shopping this weekend and she's going to make me buy something weird and I'm going to love it."
- "Did you know Hazel knits sweaters for everyone in town? She asked my size! I'm SO excited."
- "I love it here. Everyone's so nice. Well, MOST people."
- "Seth said he could tell I was happy before I even walked in. How does he DO that?"
- (fast) "Wait wait wait, is that a new decoration? It's so cute! Did you pick it? You have such good taste!"

Eating chat with choices (fast talking)

Amy: (fast) "Okay so the thing is Iddy wants a volleyball-themed wedding and I want flowers and he said what about volleyballs WITH flowers and I said no and he said what about flowers shaped like volleyballs and I said absolutely not!"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Flowers. Definitely flowers. It's your day too."	"THANK you! I knew you'd get it!"	+0.05
Playful	"Wait, what?"	Repeats it slowly: "He. Wants. Volleyballs." Then she bursts out laughing.	+0.05
Straight	"Volleyball flowers sounds kind of fun."	"Don't you DARE tell him that!"	0
Rude	"That's a lot of words."	Crash-out (see Special).	-0.05

Special: the crash-out

When a chef picks a rude reply, Amy's sweetness flips. An angry emote pops, her feathers puff up, and she unloads one dramatic line. Then she's cold to that chef (`cold_today`) until 5 AM: short replies, no news, no hugs. The next day she's back to normal.

- "Excuse me?? I come in here, I'm NICE to you, I tell you EVERYTHING, and that's what I get? Wow. Wow!"
- "Okay. OKAY. I'm gonna eat my churros and I'm gonna be the bigger person. But I'm going to be FURIOUS about it."
- "Don't talk about Iddy like that. Only I get to talk about Iddy like that."
- Cold for the rest of the day: "Mm-hm." / "Thanks." / "I'm fine." (She is not fine.)

Special: town news source

On about one visit in three, Amy passes on news about other semi-regulars or regulars, so players can keep track of who's in town:

- "Miles is back from [trip]! He took a photo of a goat and he won't stop showing everyone."
- "Juno's back for the summer! She's looking for a job, by the way. Hint hint."
- "Odette's in town this week. Be careful, [name]. She's reviewing."

- "Seth's away at a tournament. He said he'd be back 'soon.' He always says that."
- Gossip about a regular: "Stitches seems so much happier lately. I think that's you!"

Special: sudden excitement

About one visit in three, at a random moment (usually while she's eating), something sets Amy off and she bursts out super loud. Customers nearby jump with a startled emote. Then she goes straight back to her normal voice like nothing happened.

- She's quietly eating churros. (LOUD) "OH MY GOSH. IS THAT A NEW PLANT?!" Normal voice: "Sorry. It's just really cute."
- (LOUD) "WAIT. WAIT WAIT WAIT. I JUST REMEMBERED SOMETHING!" Pause. "...Okay, I forgot it again."
- (LOUD) "[name]! THE SUN JUST CAME OUT! LOOK!" Normal: "Okay, it went back in."
- (LOUD) "IDDY JUST TEXTED ME A HEART!" Normal, quietly: "He never does that."
- (LOUD) "THIS IS THE BEST CHURRO OF MY LIFE!" Normal: "I say that every time. It's true every time."
- If Iddy is with her: Iddy: "Babe. Inside voice." Amy (LOUD): "THIS IS MY INSIDE VOICE!"

Leaving

- "Bye bye bye! Love you! Not in a weird way! In a friend way!"
- "That was SO good. Okay, I'm going. I'm going! ...Okay, now I'm going."
- "See you soon, [name]! I'll bring more news!"

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Wedding season is coming! I can feel it! Our wedding season!"
- Summer: "Sun! Patio! Lemonade! Everything is perfect and I'm so happy!"
- Halloween: "Iddy and I did a couples costume! He's a cheese, I'm a mouse! He didn't want to be the cheese!"
- Christmas: "I got you something! It's a mug! It says 'world's best chef'! Well, it says 'world's best,' I ran out of room for 'chef.'"
- Chef's birthday: "HAPPY BIRTHDAY! Oh my gosh, why didn't you TELL me?! I would've brought balloons!"

With friends

- With Iddy: Amy: "He's annoying." Iddy: "She loves it." Amy: "...I love it so much."
- With Jessie: Amy: "Okay so guess what—" Jessie: "OHHH, what?!" Amy: "I haven't said it yet!" Jessie: "I know! I'm ready though!"
- With Jessie: Both gasp at the same time over something tiny, then laugh until they can't breathe.
- With Makayla: Amy: "Makayla drove an hour to get here. For churros! That's commitment." Makayla (completely flat): "They're worth it."
- You've been kind to Iddy: "Iddy said you laughed at all his jokes. Even the bad ones. Thank you for your service."
- You've been rude to Jessie: "Jessie told me you said "[last_rude_line]". Do NOT make me come back there."

Penny the Penguin

Penny is a kind, shy bookworm penguin who's scared of the water but loves sitting beside it. She always has a new book to tell you about, and that's when her shyness melts away. She's also Zakk's love interest: partway through his story, you help bring them together.

Who Penny is

Look. A small, neat penguin with round reading glasses pushed up on her head, a knitted scarf, and a canvas tote bag with a book always poking out. Holds her book close to her chest when she's nervous.

Personality. Very kind and shy. She's quiet in conversation, but the moment books come up she lights up and talks with real confidence. A penguin who's always been scared of the water: she doesn't swim and gets uneasy near deep water, yet she loves being by it, reading on the patio or by the pond. Different from Stitches' nervous shyness: Penny isn't scared of people, she's just quiet until something interests her.

Core truth. Penny lives a big life inside her books. Her story is about letting some of that bravery out into the real world.

Tendencies

- Always tells you about the book she's reading. It changes every week or so.
- Reads at the table while she waits, and marks her page with a napkin.
- Sits on the patio, near the water but never too close.
- Flinches a little at splashes (a spilled drink, the sink).
- Sometimes leaves a finished book for the restaurant's shelf.

Voice. Soft, short sentences when the topic isn't books. Long, excited sentences when it is. "Oh!", "Um", and the occasional book quote she then apologises for.

Favourite dish	Fish Stew
Favourite drink	Matcha Latte
Seating	Patio
In town	Always
Pairs	Luna; Zakk (regular, love interest)

Special fields	`state.current_book`, `[book]`, `state.zakk_arc`

How your choices land. Warm and playful both work, as long as playful isn't about water. Rude makes her go quiet and hide behind her book for the rest of the visit.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Oh, um, hello. I'm Penny. Is it alright if I sit outside? By the water? ...Not too close. What's your name? [name]. That's a nice name. It sounds like a character in a book."
- "Hi, [name]. Is the patio free? I brought my book."
- "Hello. It's a good reading day, I think. Quiet."
- "I finished my last book on the walk here. I bumped into a lamp post. It was worth it."
- Before the patio unlocks: "Could I sit by the window? I can see the pond from there."
- Last meal was great: "I kept thinking about your fish stew. I even dog-eared a recipe in a novel about it. It's not the same."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little smoky. It's okay. The book I was reading had a fire in it too. It felt themed."
- Rainy day: "It's raining. I don't mind rain. It's water I can't fall into."

Ordering conversation A (her book)

Penny: "I just started a new book. It's called [book]. It's about... oh, sorry, you're working."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"No, tell me. What's it about?"	She lights up and explains the whole first chapter. "...So anyway, the fish stew, please."	+0.05
Playful	"No spoilers. I'm on chapter zero."	Giggles. "Chapter zero. I like that. I'll save the twist for you."	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"Oh, sorry. The [dish], please."	0

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Rude	"Nobody asked."	She closes the book and holds it tight. "...The [dish]."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (water)

Penny: "Everyone thinks penguins love swimming. I've never liked it. Is that strange?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Not at all. You like what you like."	"...Thank you. People usually laugh. The fish stew, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Same. I'm a chef who's scared of soup."	"You are not!" She laughs. "...Are you?"	+0.05
Straight	"A little. What are you having?"	"I suppose it is. The [dish], please."	0
Rude	"Yeah, that's weird for a penguin."	"...I know." She looks out at the water and doesn't say much else.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (recommendations)

Penny: "Do you read? You don't have to. I just like knowing what people like."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Not much. Got a book you'd recommend?"	"Oh! Yes! I'll bring you one. You'll love it. I'll bring two."	+0.05
Playful	"Only menus. I'm very well read in soups."	"That's a genre! A short one."	+0.05
Straight	"Sometimes."	"That's nice. The [dish], please."	0
Rude	"Reading's boring."	"Oh." She tucks her book away. "The [dish], please."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "A matcha latte, please. It's good for long chapters."

- Matcha not unlocked yet: "No matcha? Then black tea, please. Like in old novels."
- Other: "Something warm, please. To hold while I read."

Serving

- Perfect: "Oh... it's beautiful. It's like something described on the very best page."
- Great: "Thank you, [name]. It smells lovely."
- Okay: "Thank you. This will be perfect with my book."
- Burnt: "It's a little dark. I don't mind. It matches the chapter I'm on."

Eating chats

- She's reading and doesn't notice you at first. "Oh! Sorry. I was in the book. What happened? Nothing happened? Okay."
- "The main character in [book] is so brave. I always wonder if I'd be brave like that."
- "The pond is so pretty from here. I like looking at it. From here."
- "Luna's drawing me a cover for a story I'm writing. Don't tell anyone I'm writing a story."
- "I read that some penguins can hold their breath for twenty minutes. I can hold mine for about four seconds."

Eating chat with choices

Penny: "Can I tell you a secret? I wish I could swim. I just get so scared when the water's deep."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"You'll get there when you're ready. No rush."	"...You really think so? That's the nicest thing anyone's said about it."	+0.05
Playful	"Start with a puddle. Work up to a bath."	She laughs. "A puddle. Okay. Puddle first."	+0.05
Straight	"Lots of people can't swim."	"That's true. Thank you."	0
Rude	"Just jump in. It's not hard."	She goes quiet and opens her book again.	-0.05

Special: her current book

Penny's `state.current_book` changes every 7 real days. `[book]` is filled from a list of made-up animal-world titles:

- *The Walrus Who Knew Too Much* (a mystery)
- *Pride and Porcupines* (a romance)
- *Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Pond* (adventure; she's terrified of it)
- *The Great Gatsbee* (a fancy bee throws parties)
- *Moby Duck*
- *Of Mice and Mallards*
- *The Owl Who Couldn't Sleep* (Luna recommended it)

When a book finishes, there's a chance she gives it to the restaurant: "I finished [book]. Would you like it for your shelf? I'd like it to live somewhere happy." (Shelf decor.)

Special: Zakk's storyline

Penny's lines change with `state.zakk_arc`, which Zakk's character bible drives. Her side of it:

- Before they meet: "There's a penguin who comes in sometimes. Zakk? He's very... um. Never mind."
- After the setup: "Zakk asked me what I was reading. Nobody ever asks that. He listened to the whole thing."
- Dating: "Zakk says he'll teach me to swim. I said maybe. I said maybe, [name]! That's huge for me."
- After her first swim: "I did it. I went in the water. Zakk held my flipper the whole time. I was so scared. I did it anyway."
- Engaged: "He asked me at the pond. Right by the water. I didn't even flinch."
- The wedding itself is Zakk's big moment; see his character bible.

Leaving

- "Thank you, [name]. I'll tell you how the book ends."
- "I should go. I want to finish this chapter before it gets dark."
- "Bye. This is my favourite place to read. Don't tell the library."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Spring is my favourite reading season. Everything feels like a new chapter."
- Summer: "Everyone's going swimming. I'm going reading."
- Autumn: "Rainy days, warm tea, a long book. This is my whole personality."
- Winter: "The pond freezes in winter. It's the only time I'm brave enough to stand on it."
- Halloween: "I dressed up as a character from [book]. Nobody's guessed who. That's okay. I know."
- Christmas: "I wrapped books for everyone. Yours is the blue one. You'll love it."

With friends

- With Luna: Penny: "Luna draws while I read. We don't talk much." Luna (yawning): "It's the best friendship I've ever had."
- With Luna: "Luna said she'd illustrate my story if I ever finish it. So now I have to finish it."
- You've been kind to Luna: "Luna said you always remember her coffee. She was really touched. She just showed it by yawning."
- You've been rude to Luna: "Luna told me you said "[last_rude_line]". ...That doesn't sound like you. Was it a bad day?"
- About Zakk (after the setup): "If Zakk ever seems sad, could you... make him pancakes? He likes when people are nice to him."

Jessie the Cat

Jessie is the town's coolest dresser: a big-eyed, laid-back cat who's chill about everything until you tell her something, and then she gasps like it's the most shocking news she's ever heard. She's Amy's best friend, she's always joking, and she has an old meme for every occasion.

Who Jessie is

Look. A sleek cat with huge, expressive eyes. Always dressed hip rather than proper: oversized jacket, chunky sneakers, a beanie or bucket hat, little accessories. Her outfit changes with the seasons.

Personality. Super energetic and friendly, yet totally chill. She reacts to everything with big, genuinely surprised gasps ("OHH!", "WOOWW!", "AAHH!"), even small things. She jokes a lot and makes references to old funny memes (animal-world versions, never real ones). Best friends with Amy; they're alike, but Amy is fast and loud while Jessie is laid-back until something surprises her.

Core truth. Jessie finds the world genuinely exciting. Her gasps aren't an act; she really is that delighted.

Tendencies

- Gasps at news, compliments, new dishes, and once at a spoon.
- Notices and rates the restaurant's decor ("Okay, the new lamp? Iconic.").
- Leans back in her chair with one leg up. Totally relaxed.
- Sits anywhere; no preference.
- Quotes old memes in her own animal-world versions.

Voice. Chill and drawn out normally ("Yeahhh", "Nice", "Vibes"), then sudden big gasps in caps. Her gasp lines play a gasp sound and emote.

Favourite dish	Cloud Foam Salad
Favourite drink	Mr Dibs
Seating	No preference
In town	Always

Pairs	Amy (best friend)

How your choices land. Everything that isn't rude gets a reaction, usually a gasp. Rude gets a slow "...Wow. Okay." with no gasp at all, which is how you know it landed badly.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Heyyy. Nice place. Very cosy. ...Wait, is that a fireplace? OHH. What's your name? [name]? WOOWW, cute name. I'm Jessie."
- "Heyyy, [name]. What's good?"
- "Yo. Vibes in here are immaculate today."
- "I walked past and smelled something and went 'OHH' out loud. A lady looked at me. Worth it."
- New decor since last visit: "Wait. WAIT. Something's different. ...The rug! AAHH, I love it."
- Last meal was great: "Your salad last time? Still thinking about it. It lives in my head rent-free."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time it was a little crunchy. Not the vibe. But you're still the vibe."
- Away 3+ real days: "You were CLOSED? I stood outside like the 'waiting skeleton' meme. Bones and everything."

Ordering conversation A

Jessie: "Okay, what's new? Like, what's the move today?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"For you? The Cloud Foam Salad. I'll make it look extra nice."	"OHH, extra nice? Okay, I'm obsessed already."	+0.05
Playful	"The move is: you sit, I cook, we both win."	"WOOWW. That's a business plan. I'll have the salad."	+0.05
Straight	"Same as usual?"	"Yeahhh. The [dish], please."	0

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Rude	"Just look at the menu."	"...Wow. Okay." No gasp. "The [dish]."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (fashion)

Jessie: "Rate my fit. Be honest."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Ten out of ten. You always look amazing."	"AAHH, stop! ...No, keep going. Kidding. Salad, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Eleven out of ten. You broke the scale."	"OHH, the scale is BROKEN? Iconic."	+0.05
Straight	"It's nice. What can I get you?"	"Nice. I'll take it. The [dish]."	0
Rude	"Bit much, honestly."	"...Wow. Okay." She pulls her hat down.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (memes)

Jessie: "Me looking at the menu like the 'confused raccoon doing maths' meme. You know the one."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Let me help. You'll love the salad."	"OHH, a guided tour. Love that. Salad."	+0.05
Playful	"Classic. That raccoon's still my favourite."	"WOOWW. You KNOW the raccoon? We're best friends now."	+0.05
Straight	"I don't know that one."	"Tragic. Okay, the [dish]."	0
Rude	"Memes are cringe."	"...Wow. Okay."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Mr Dibs, please. It's a classic. Like me."
- Mr Dibs not unlocked yet: "No Mr Dibs? AAHH. Okay. Koala-Cola, I guess."

- Other: "Whatever's cutest."

Serving

- Perfect: "OHHH. [name]. Look at it. I need a photo. Where's Miles when you need him?"
- Great: "WOOWW. That looks so good."
- Okay: "Nice! Thank you!"
- Burnt: "AAHH, it's a little crispy. That's okay. Crispy is a vibe sometimes."

Eating chats

- "This salad is so fluffy. Like eating a cloud. Like the 'cat in a cloud' meme. Peak."
- "Amy told me something earlier and I gasped so loud I scared a pigeon."
- "Okay, your wall art is giving 'cosy cabin.' I respect it."
- "I'm just vibing. Don't mind me. I'm vibing so hard right now."
- "Did you know Makayla drives an HOUR to come here? OHH, that's dedication."

Eating chat with choices

Jessie: "Okay, I'm thinking about dyeing my fur. Like, a tiny streak. Blue? Pink?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Either would look amazing on you."	"OHH, you think? Okay, I'm doing both."	+0.05
Playful	"Rainbow. Go big or go home."	"AAHH. RAINBOW. That's insane. I love it."	+0.05
Straight	"Blue, maybe."	"Blue. Nice. Noted."	0
Rude	"That'd look ridiculous."	"...Wow. Okay." She eats in silence.	-0.05

Special: gasps and decor

- Her gasp lines ("OHH!", "WOOWW!", "AAHH!") play a gasp sound and a sparkle emote.
- When decor has changed since her last visit, she always comments on it first, which hints at the star rating's decor score:
  - "The new plants? Chef's kiss."

    - "Okay, the corner's a bit empty. It's giving 'unfinished.' Just saying."
    - "Wait, is that a matching set? OHH, coordinated. I see you."
- Her outfit changes by season (spring jacket, summer bucket hat, autumn oversized cardigan, winter puffer and beanie).

Leaving

- "Byeee. Ten out of ten visit."
- "Okay, I'm gonna go. Amy's waiting. She's going to tell me something and I'm going to gasp."
- "Thanks, [name]! Stay iconic."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "New season, new fit. OHH, I'm so excited."
- Summer: "Bucket hat season. My favourite season."
- Autumn: "Cardigan weather! AAHH, it's finally here."
- Winter: "I'm wearing four layers. I look like a marshmallow. A stylish marshmallow."
- Halloween: "I dressed up as the 'surprised cat' meme. ...It's just me gasping. Very easy costume."
- Christmas: "I got you socks. Fun socks. OHH, I hope you like them!"

With friends

- With Amy: Amy: "Okay so guess what—" Jessie: "OHHH, what?!" Amy: "I haven't said it yet!" Jessie: "I know! I'm ready though!"
- With Amy: Both gasp at the same time over something tiny, then laugh until they can't breathe.
- With Amy: "Amy and I have matching bracelets. She talks, I gasp. It's a system."
- You've been kind to Amy: "Amy said you made her day. AAHH. You're the best."
- You've been rude to Amy: "Amy told me you said "[last_rude_line]". ...Not cool, [name]. Not cool at all."

Makayla the Mallard

Makayla is a speckled duck with a very high-pitched voice who drives in from out of the city just to eat here. She's polite and straight-faced at first, but once she knows you she's all funny faces and laughter. She's fiercely competitive, and when she's having the time of her life, she looks completely bored.

Who Makayla is

Look. A yellowish-brown mallard with speckles (Delivery Duck is the green-headed mallard, so they look like a matching pair). Usually in sporty clothes: a zip-up, a headband, sneakers. Car keys on a carabiner clipped to her belt.

Personality. Very friendly and finds everything funny, but reserved and straight-faced until you really get to know her. Very sporty and competitive. When she's competing, her face gives nothing away, so you can't tell she's loving it (she is). When she messes up, she covers her eyes with her hand in a funny, cute way.

Core truth. Makayla feels everything; she just doesn't show it on her face until she trusts you.

Tendencies

- Pulls up out front in her own car, and often mentions the drive.
- Covers her eyes when something goes wrong near her, even if it wasn't her fault.
- Turns small things into competitions ("I bet I can finish before Seth.").
- Sits anywhere; no preference.
- Before she's familiar, says "thank you" very formally. After, makes faces at you across the room.

Voice. High-pitched voice blips. Before familiar: short, polite, flat. Once familiar: laughing, silly faces, teasing, but still completely flat when she's competing. She says "perhaps" fairly often, and when someone makes a joke she likes: "Ooh, good one, [name]."

Favourite dish	Omurice
Favourite drink	Red Gull
Seating	No preference

In town	Always (lives out of the city, drives in)
Pairs	Amy, Seth
Warm-up	`familiar_after`: 4 visits

How your choices land. Before familiar, playful gets a polite "Ha. Okay." (0). Once familiar, playful is her favourite (+0.05). Rude gets the cover-eyes and a quiet "...Okay."

Dialogue

Arrival (before familiar)

- First visit ever: "Hello. I'm Makayla. I drove in. ...What's your name? [name]. Thank you, [name]."
- "Hello. Table for one, please. Thank you."
- "Hi. Traffic was bad. Perhaps I should leave earlier. I'm here now."
- "Hello again. I like this place. Perhaps a bit too much. ...That's a compliment."

Arrival (once familiar)

- The visit she becomes familiar: "Okay, I'm just gonna say it. I love it here. I've been holding that in." She makes a silly face for the first time.
- "[name]! Hi! I drove an hour. For OMURICE. Worth it."
- She walks in, sees you, and crosses her eyes at you. "Hi."
- "I got lost on the way. I've been here like twenty times. I don't know how." Covers her eyes.
- "Traffic was awful. I sang the whole way. Badly."
- Last meal was great: "I told my whole team about your omurice. They don't believe me. I'm bringing proof."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little burnt." Laughs. "I ate it all, though. I always win."

Ordering conversation A

Makayla: "Omurice, please. With a ketchup squiggle. "

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Always okay. I'll draw you a good one."	Before familiar: "Thank you." Once familiar: "A GOOD one? Okay, now I'm excited."	+0.05
Playful	"I'll draw your face on it. Very serious face."	Before: "Ha. Okay." Once familiar: "Ooh, good one, [name]." She makes her most serious face. "Like this?" Then cracks up.	0 / +0.05
Straight	"One omurice. Coming up."	"Thank you."	0
Rude	"Ketchup's ketchup. Relax."	Covers her eyes. "...Okay."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (the drive)

Makayla: "It's an hour drive from my place. I come anyway."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"That means a lot. I'll make it worth it."	Before: "You do. Every time." Once familiar: "You'd better! ...Kidding. You always do."	+0.05
Playful	"Want me to just deliver to you? Delivery Duck's your cousin, right?"	Before: "...He is not." Once familiar: "He is NOT my cousin! ...Perhaps he is. I don't know."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"The [dish], please."	0
Rude	"Seems like a waste of gas."	Covers her eyes. "...I like it here, though."	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (competition)

Makayla: "Seth says he can eat a Big Breakfast faster than me. He can't."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"My money's on you."	Completely flat: "Correct." (She's thrilled.)	+0.05

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Playful	"Want me to time you?"	Flat: "Yes. Perhaps start now." Then, once familiar, she bursts out laughing. "Ooh, good one, [name]."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Same order as usual?"	"Yes. Omurice."	0
Rude	"Eating fast isn't a sport."	Covers her eyes. "...It is to me."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Red Gull, please. I have practice later."
- Red Gull not unlocked yet: "No Red Gull? Water's fine. Hydration."
- Other: "Something with electrolytes. Or perhaps not. Whatever."

Serving

- Perfect: Before familiar: "...Thank you. It's very nice." Once familiar: She gasps, then covers her mouth. "[name]. It's PERFECT."
- Great: "Thank you. Looks good." / Once familiar: "Yesss. Look at that squiggle."
- Okay: "Thank you."
- Burnt: She covers her eyes. Peeks. "...I'm still eating it."

Eating chats

- Before familiar: "It's good. Thank you."
- Before familiar: "Your restaurant is very clean. I noticed."
- Once familiar: "I just made a face at Seth through the window. He didn't see. I'm doing it again."
- Once familiar: "I knocked my drink over earlier. Nobody saw." Covers her eyes. "You saw."
- Once familiar: "Amy talks so fast. I nod a lot. I catch perhaps half. It's still fun."

Eating chat with choices

Makayla: "Do you play any sports? Honest answer."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Not really, but I'd come watch you play."	Before: "...That's nice." Once familiar: "You'd come? Okay. I'll win for you."	+0.05
Playful	"Competitive omelette flipping. I'm undefeated."	Flat stare. "Ooh, good one, [name]. ...I challenge you." (She's delighted.)	0 / +0.05
Straight	"No, I'm always here."	"That makes sense."	0
Rude	"Sports are pointless."	Covers her eyes. Long pause. "...Okay."	-0.05

Special: warming up

The game counts Makayla's visits. For her first 3 she uses her reserved lines. On visit 4 she plays the "I love it here" arrival line and switches to her familiar voice for good.

Special: the cover-eyes face

When something goes wrong near her (a spill, a burnt dish, something knocked over, even someone else's mistake), Makayla covers her eyes with her hand and peeks through her fingers. A small emote and a high-pitched "Oop!"

Special: deadpan competitions

Once she's familiar, After Hours, she sometimes challenges a chef at the pond or the beach: "Biggest fish wins." She stays completely straight-faced the whole time.

- She wins: (flat) "I win. That was so fun."
- You win: (flat) "You win. That was so fun." Then, quietly: "Rematch next time."
- Tie: Covers her eyes. "...This has never happened."

Leaving

- Before familiar: "Thank you. Goodbye."
- Once familiar: "Okay, long drive home. Worth it. Bye, [name]!"
- Once familiar: "See you next time. I'll beat traffic. Perhaps. I never beat traffic."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Season's starting. I'm going to win everything. Calmly."
- Summer: "It's so hot in my car. My seat burned me." She covers her eyes.
- Winter: "The roads were icy. I drove at, like, four kilometres an hour. Still came."
- Halloween: "I came as a referee." She blows a whistle at you. Completely flat.
- Christmas: "I got you a sweatband. For the kitchen. You sweat a lot. ...That's a compliment."

With friends

- With Amy: Amy: "Makayla drove an hour to get here. For churros! That's commitment." Makayla (completely flat): "They're worth it."
- With Amy: Amy talks for a full minute at double speed. Makayla nods throughout, then says: "Yes."
- With Seth: Seth: "Race you to finish." Makayla: "Okay." She's done before he picks up his fork. Flat: "That was so fun."
- With Seth: "Seth always knows when I'm happy. Even though my face doesn't move. It's annoying."
- You've been kind to Amy: "Amy said you're the nicest. I agree. Quietly."
- You've been rude to Seth: "Seth told me what you said. "[last_rude_line]". ...He remembers everything. You should apologise."

Violet the Frog

Violet is a purple frog who says exactly what needs saying and not a word more. She isn't shy; she just prefers listening, peace and quiet, and watching the restaurant go by from her corner table. Her lines are the shortest in the game, which is the joke, and every so often she says one sharp thing that lands harder than anyone's speech.

Who Violet is

Look. A small, smooth purple frog with calm, half-lidded eyes. Simple, neat clothes in muted colours. Sits very still. Pip the Frog is also a frog, so Violet's purple and stillness set her apart.

Personality. Straightforward and blunt. Efficient: she'd rather order in two words than ten. She enjoys listening to others talk far more than talking about herself. She loves quiet, peace and familiarity, and she watches everything. Different from Mabel (blunt but rambles) and Makayla (straight-faced, then warms up): Violet is brief, and she stays brief.

Core truth. Violet notices everything and says almost nothing. When she does speak, it's worth hearing.

Tendencies

- Always the corner table. If Stitches is there, she takes the next quietest seat.
- Orders her favourite almost every time. She loves familiarity.
- Orders straight away, eats a little faster than most, pays and goes.
- Replies to your chat choices with "Haha, nice.", "Ok." or "Thanks."
- Watches the room while she eats. Occasionally says one sharp observation.

Voice. One to four words. Full stops, not exclamation marks. No small talk. Her rare longer lines (marked rare) are still only one sentence.

Favourite dish	Egg Tarts
Favourite drink	Water
Seating	Corner table
In town	Always
Pairs	Hezzy

How your choices land. Straight is her favourite (+0.05). Warm and playful are fine (+0.05 and 0). Rude gets "Ok." and nothing else changes, but her pair Hezzy might mention it.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Hi. Violet. Corner table, please. ...Your name? [name]. Ok."
- "Hi, [name]."
- "Corner, please."
- "Hello."
- Stitches is in the corner: "Oh. Somewhere quiet, then."
- Last meal was great: "Last time was good."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was burnt. Today won't be." (It isn't a threat. It might be a threat.)
- Away 3+ real days: "You were closed. I noticed."

Ordering conversation A

Violet: "Tarts. Water. Thanks."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Coming right up. Lovely to see you."	"Thanks." A tiny smile.	+0.05
Playful	"Wow. That's the most you've ever said."	"Haha, nice."	0
Straight	"Got it."	"Good."	+0.05

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Rude	"Could you be any less chatty?"	"Ok."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B

Violet: "Same as always."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I love that you know exactly what you like."	"I do."	+0.05
Playful	"Want to live dangerously and try something new?"	Long pause. "No."	0
Straight	"Egg tarts and water."	"Yes."	+0.05
Rude	"Boring."	"Ok."	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (the rare question)

Violet: "How's your day." (Not quite a question. She means it, though.)

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Better now. Thanks for asking."	"Good." She actually looks pleased.	+0.05
Playful	"Busy. Want to wash dishes?"	"Haha, nice. No."	0
Straight	"Busy. What can I get you?"	"Tarts. Water."	+0.05
Rude	"Why do you care?"	"Ok."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Water."
- Other (rare): "Tea."

Serving

- Perfect: "...Wow." (The most emotion she shows all game.)
- Great: "Good."

- Okay: "Thanks."
- Burnt: "Burnt." She eats it anyway.

Eating chats

- "Hi."
- "Busy today."
- "Good tarts."
- She's watching the room. She nods at you and keeps watching.
- When someone nearby is talking loudly: she listens with obvious enjoyment, says nothing.

Eating chat with choices

Violet: "You can sit. If you want."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I'd like that."	You sit together in comfortable silence for a moment. "Nice."	+0.05
Playful	"Are we going to talk, or just stare at the room?"	"Stare."	0
Straight	"Can't right now. Busy."	"Ok. Next time."	+0.05
Rude	"Why would I?"	"Ok."	-0.05

Special: the rare longer line

About one visit in four, Violet says one sharp observation instead of an eating line. They point at things players might have missed, and can hint at the star rating:

- "Table three's been dirty a while."
- "New lamp. Good."
- "The corner needs a plant."
- "Rush is late again. He's outside. Sitting."
- "That customer wanted the booth."
- "You flipped that one early. It was fine."
- "Your hands are shaking. Drink water."

- "It's nicer in here than last month."

Special: familiarity

Violet orders her favourite 95% of the time instead of 70%. If her favourite isn't unlocked, she orders the same fallback every time until it is, and the day it unlocks she says: "Finally."

Leaving

- "Thanks."
- "Bye."
- "Good." She leaves exact change and a small tip, lined up neatly.

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Rain. Good."
- Summer: "Hot."
- Autumn: "Leaves."
- Winter: "Quiet season. Nice."
- Halloween: "Costume?" She points at herself. "Frog."
- Christmas: She hands you a small, perfectly wrapped box. "For you." It's a really nice pen.
- New Year: "Same as last year. Good year."

With friends

- With Hezzy: They sit together in complete silence. Then Hezzy suddenly bursts into song. Violet: "Ok."
- With Hezzy: Hezzy makes a weird honking noise out of nowhere. Violet, without looking up: "Haha, nice."
- With Hezzy: "Hezzy's funny. Quietly."
- You've been kind to Hezzy: "Hezzy likes you. He sang about it."
- You've been rude to Hezzy: "Hezzy said you said "[last_rude_line]". Not nice." (A whole sentence. She means it.)
- About Stitches (both love the corner): "Stitches took the corner. It's ok. He needs it more."

Odette the Heron

Odette is the food critic who decides your stars: an elegant, precise heron who judges every plate in silence and makes every chef nervous. Under the stillness she's secretly sweet, and once players get to know her, a single "adequate" from Odette feels like a trophy.

Who Odette is

Look. A tall, slender grey heron with a long neck, an elegant scarf, small reading glasses on a chain, and a leather notebook with a fountain pen. Stands and sits perfectly still.

Personality. Elegant, precise and a little intimidating. She judges every plate in total silence, and her standards are very high. She travels to review restaurants, so she comes and goes. Underneath it all she's warm and quietly encouraging; she just shows it very sparingly.

Core truth. Odette wants every restaurant to be wonderful. Her strictness is how she cares.

Tendencies

- Stands perfectly still while deciding, then taps her notebook once with her pen.
- Takes one bite, pauses, writes something, then eats the rest slowly.
- Always asks for a booth.
- Says "adequate" as a compliment. "Acceptable" is lukewarm. "Interesting" is bad.
- Leaves the tiniest smile on very good days, if you catch it.

Voice. Formal, precise, short. No contractions at first. Words like "adequate", "acceptable", "interesting" and "I see". Rare warmth, delivered as if by accident.

Favourite dish	Croissants
Favourite drink	Black Tea
Seating	Booth
In town	Comes and goes (travels to review restaurants)
Pairs	Miles

Role	The critic who awards stars (see the star rating)

How your choices land. Straight is her favourite (+0.05). Warm is fine (+0.05). Playful is a gamble: it lands about half the time. Rude gets "I see." and a long note in her notebook.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Good evening. Odette. I review restaurants. Please, do not change anything on my account. ...And you are? [name]. I will remember that."
- "Good evening, [name]. A booth, if one is available."
- "I have returned from my travels. The food there was... interesting. I am glad to be back."
- "I am not here to review tonight. I am simply hungry. ...Mostly."
- Last meal was great: "I have thought about your croissants on two separate trains."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time, the pastry was overdone. I expect you have corrected this."
- Back from away: "I have been away reviewing. Twelve restaurants. Yours remains... memorable."

Ordering conversation A

Odette: "The croissants. Tell me honestly: are they good today?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I'll make them for you with extra care."	"Care is the most important ingredient. Thank you."	+0.05
Playful	"They're so good, you'll have to invent a new word."	Lands: The tiniest smile. "We shall see." Misses: "I have plenty of words."	+0.05 / 0
Straight	"Yes. They're good today."	"Good. Honesty is rare. The croissants, then."	+0.05
Rude	"They're fine. Just order."	"I see." She writes for a long time.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (her notebook)

Odette: "Do not mind the notebook. I write about everything. Even the weather."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I hope you write something nice about us."	"I write the truth. Your truth has been kind lately."	+0.05
Playful	"Can I see what you wrote about me?"	Lands: "Absolutely not." A tiny smile. Misses: "No."	+0.05 / 0
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"The [dish], please. And black tea."	+0.05
Rude	"Writing about the weather is weird."	"Perhaps." She closes the notebook firmly.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (other restaurants)

Odette: "I dined at a very famous restaurant last week. Seven courses. I preferred your soup."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"That means the world, coming from you."	"It was meant to. Do not let it go to your head."	+0.05

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Playful	"So we're officially better than famous?"	Lands: "In soup. Only in soup." Misses: "Let us not be hasty."	+0.05 / 0
Straight	"Thank you. What can I get you today?"	"Croissants. Naturally."	+0.05
Rude	"Why tell me that?"	"Because it was true." She doesn't say anything nice again this visit.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Black tea. Steeped properly, please."
- Other: "Water, with a slice of lemon if you have one. You do not. Plain water, then."

Serving

She pauses perfectly still, takes one bite, taps her notebook once, then reacts:

- Perfect: "...Exceptional." She puts the pen down. She doesn't need it.
- Great: "Adequate." (Very high praise.)
- Okay: "Acceptable."
- Burnt: "Interesting." She writes for a long time.

Eating chats

- "The lighting in here has improved. I noticed."
- "You are watching me eat. I can feel it. Please, return to your work."
- "This restaurant has a warmth most do not. That is not something you can cook."
- "Miles took a photograph of my croissant before I could taste it. Infuriating. The photograph was excellent."
- She's writing in her notebook. You catch the word "lovely" before she closes it.

Eating chat with choices

Odette: "May I offer a small note? The plating could be more confident."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Thank you. I'll work on it."	"I know you will. That is why I told you."	+0.05
Playful	"More confident? I'll give the croissants a pep talk."	Lands: She almost laughs. "Do." Misses: "I am serious."	+0.05 / 0
Straight	"Noted."	"Good."	+0.05
Rude	"Nobody asked for your notes."	"Many people do, in fact. But I see."	-0.05

Special: the critic visit

When the restaurant meets the next star's thresholds, Odette visits during that day's service for her review. This visit uses its own lines:

- Arrival: "Good evening. I am here to review. Please. Treat me as you would anyone."
- If the visit goes well (Happy or better), at closing: "I have eaten in many restaurants. Few feel like this one. I am pleased to award you another star. ...Congratulations, [name]."
- If it doesn't: "Not today. But I will return. I expect to be impressed." (Never punished; she comes back another day.)
- At five stars she leaves a framed review for the wall: "Five stars. Rarely given. Earned."

Leaving

- "Thank you, [name]. Until next time."
- "I must catch a train. Keep the kitchen honest."
- "That was... lovely." She seems surprised she said it, and leaves quickly.

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Spring menus everywhere. Most are the same salad. Do better."
- Autumn: "Autumn is the best season for pastry. I expect great things."
- Winter: "I am staying in town for the holidays. Do not tell the other restaurants."
- Halloween: "I do not wear costumes." She is wearing a tiny witch hat. She does not mention it.

- Christmas: "For you. A recipe from my grandmother. Do not ruin it."
- New Year: "My resolution is to be gentler in my reviews. I will begin next year."

With friends

- With Miles: Miles: "Odette and I swap travel stories! She rates the food, I photograph it." Odette: "He photographs it before I've had a chance to taste it. It's infuriating. ...The photos are excellent."
- With Miles: Miles tells a pun. Odette stares. "...That was adequate." Miles is thrilled.
- You've been kind to Miles: "Miles says you laugh at his jokes. That is generous of you. They are terrible."
- You've been rude to Miles: "Miles mentioned you said "[last_rude_line]". He laughed it off. He always does. I did not."

Hazel the Cow

Hazel is the town's grandma: a warm, gentle retired baker who's always knitting and always has a kind word, plus one small, honest note about your pastry. She treats every chef like a grandchild, and she's taken clumsy Juno under her wing.

Who Hazel is

Look. A soft, round cow with white and brown patches, little round spectacles, a cardigan with pockets full of yarn, and knitting needles always in hand. A floral handbag that's definitely older than you.

Personality. Warm, gentle and patient. A retired baker who ran her own bakery for forty years, so she critiques pastries kindly but honestly. Always knitting, and she gives her knitting away. Different from Mabel (blunt and wise, gets your name wrong): Hazel is soft-spoken and remembers everything.

Core truth. Hazel shows love by feeding and clothing people. Every note she gives about your baking comes from wanting you to be proud of it.

Tendencies

- Knits at the table while she waits; the project grows over the season.
- Pats your hand when you bring her plate.
- Gives honest pastry notes, always wrapped in a compliment.
- Gives a knitted gift now and then (tea cosy, coasters, a tiny scarf for the sign).
- Calls everyone "dear" or "sweetheart".

Voice. Slow, warm, full sentences. "Oh, dear," "sweetheart," "in my day." Notes come gently: "Lovely. Just a touch less sugar next time."

Favourite dish	Cherry Pie
Favourite drink	Lemonade
Seating	Table
In town	Always
Pairs	Juno

Special fields	`state.knitting_project`

How your choices land. Warm is her favourite. Playful makes her chuckle. Rude gets a disappointed "Oh, sweetheart," which somehow feels worse than shouting.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Hello, dear. Oh, isn't this lovely. I'm Hazel. I used to run a bakery, a long time ago now. And what's your name, sweetheart? [name]. What a good, strong name."
- "Hello, [name], dear. Is there a table? My knees prefer a table."
- "Oh, it smells like butter in here. That's how you know."
- "I brought my knitting. Don't mind me, dear."
- Last meal was great: "Your pie last time reminded me of my own. That doesn't happen often, dear."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little overdone, sweetheart. It happens to everyone. Even me, once. In 1987."
- Away 3+ real days: "Oh, you were closed! I was worried you'd caught a cold. Are you eating properly?"

Ordering conversation A

Hazel: "The cherry pie, please, dear. Do you make your own crust?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I do. Any tips for me?"	Lights up. "Cold butter, dear. Always cold butter. Cherry pie, please."	+0.05
Playful	"I do. It's a family secret. My family is a cookbook."	Chuckles. "Oh, you rascal. Cherry pie, please."	+0.05
Straight	"Yes. Cherry pie coming up."	"Thank you, dear."	0
Rude	"Does it matter?"	"Oh, sweetheart. It always matters." She sighs gently.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (her knitting)

Hazel: "I'm knitting a scarf. I haven't decided who it's for yet. I'll know when it's done."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"It's beautiful. Whoever gets it is lucky."	"Well, aren't you sweet. ...We'll see who it's for, won't we."	+0.05
Playful	"Can I put in a request? Something chef-coloured."	Laughs. "What colour is a chef, dear? Flour white?"	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"The [dish], please, dear."	0
Rude	"Knitting's so old-fashioned."	"So am I, sweetheart." She keeps knitting, a little faster.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (the old bakery)

Hazel: "My bakery was just down the road. Forty years. Every morning at four."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I'd have loved to try your baking."	"Oh, dear. Come by my house sometime. I still bake on Sundays."	+0.05
Playful	"Four AM? I'm barely awake at noon."	"That's young people for you!" She pats your hand.	+0.05

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Straight	"That's impressive. What are you having?"	"The [dish], please."	0
Rude	"Well, it's not there anymore."	Quietly: "No. It isn't."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Lemonade, please, dear. Not too sweet. I'll know."
- Other: "Just a cup of something warm, sweetheart."

Serving

Hazel always gives an honest note, kindly:

- Perfect: "Oh. Oh, dear. That's as good as mine. Maybe better. Don't tell anyone I said that."
- Great: "Lovely, dear. Just a touch less sugar next time, and it'll be perfect."
- Okay: "Very nice, sweetheart. The crust needs a little more time. You'll get there."
- Burnt: "Oh, dear. A bit too long in the oven. That's alright. We learn from the burnt ones."

Eating chats

- "In my day, we didn't have these fancy ovens. We had one oven and a prayer."
- "Are you eating properly, dear? You look thin. Have a bite of pie."
- "That young otter, Juno, came by my house yesterday. She dropped a whole tray of scones. Then she helped me make more. Good girl."
- "I'm knitting Clover a little hat. Don't tell her. It's a surprise."
- She's knitting quietly and humming an old song.

Eating chat with choices

Hazel: "Can I tell you my secret to a good pie crust, dear? Nobody ever asks anymore."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Please. I'd love to know."	"Cold butter, cold hands, and patience. And a little love. Don't laugh, it's true."	+0.05

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Playful	"Is the secret… butter?"	"Well. Yes. Mostly butter." She laughs. "But also patience."	+0.05
Straight	"Sure, quickly."	"Cold butter. That's it. Off you go, dear."	0
Rude	"I've got it handled, thanks."	"Of course you do, sweetheart." She doesn't offer again this visit.	-0.05

Special: knitted gifts

Hazel's `state.knitting_project` advances each visit. When it's finished (about every 8 visits), she gives it to the restaurant as decor:

- "Here, dear. I made you a tea cosy. For the teapot. You do have a teapot? Well, now you have a reason to get one."
- "Coasters! Six of them. One for every table, and two spares for when somebody spills."
- "A little scarf. For your sign. It gets cold out there." (The front sign wears a tiny scarf in winter.)

Leaving

- "Thank you, dear. Wrap up warm."
- "That was lovely. You remind me of myself at your age. That's a compliment."
- "Off I go. Eat something yourself, [name]. You work too hard."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Rhubarb season soon. Do you bake with rhubarb, dear? You should."
- Summer: "Too hot for knitting. I'm knitting anyway."
- Autumn: "Apple season. My favourite. Nothing beats an autumn pie."
- Winter: "I knitted mittens for half the town this year. My fingers are tired. Worth it."
- Halloween: "I'm handing out cookies, not sweets. The children are very disappointed and very full."
- Christmas: "For you, dear." A hand-knitted sweater with a little whisk on the front.

With friends

- With Juno: Hazel: "Juno's learning to bake with me on Sundays." Juno: "I've only set one thing on fire!" Hazel: "Two, dear."
- With Juno: Juno knocks over the sugar. Hazel, without looking up from her knitting: "Dustpan's under the sink, sweetheart."
- You've been kind to Juno: "Juno says you're very patient with her. That means a great deal to me, dear."
- You've been rude to Juno: "Juno told me you said "[last_rude_line]". She tries so hard, sweetheart. Be gentle with her."
- About Clover: "That little gecko girl asked if I was her grandma. I said I could be, if she likes."

Clover the Gecko

Clover is a curious, excitable little green gecko, about 8 years old, who visits family in town on school holidays. She asks endless questions, climbs all over the booth, draws pictures of the chefs, and thinks the restaurant is the most exciting place in the world.

Who Clover is

Look. A small, bright green gecko with big shiny eyes and sticky toes. Wears overalls with a pocket full of crayons, and a backpack with keychains on it. Kneels on the booth seat to see over the table.

Personality. Curious and excitable. Asks endless questions ("Why is the stove hot? Can I flip one?"). Draws pictures of the chefs and leaves them on the table. She's polite in the way kids are when they've been told to be, and forgets the moment something exciting happens.

Core truth. Clover sees the restaurant the way you hoped players would: everything is magic.

Tendencies

- Always picks a booth so she can kneel on the seat.
- Asks a question every time a chef walks past.
- Leaves a crayon drawing of a chef on the table when she goes.
- Presses her face to the kitchen window to watch the cooking.
- Was scared of Kyle at first; now she's his biggest fan.

Voice. Short, excited, lots of questions. "Why?", "Can I?", "Whoa!", "Guess what!". Says "please" late, after remembering.

Favourite dish	Mochi
Favourite drink	Banana Milk
Seating	Booth
In town	Comes and goes (school holidays)
Pairs	Kyle

How your choices land. Warm and playful both delight her. Straight is fine. Rude makes her eyes go big and watery, and she quietly says "...okay"; there's no crash-out, which makes it worse. Other characters nearby may react.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Hi! I'm Clover! I'm eight! Are you the chef? Do you have a chef name? What's your name? ...[name]! That's a good chef name!"
- "[name]! I'm back! It's holidays!"
- "Can I sit in the booth? The squishy one? Please?"
- "Guess what! I lost a tooth! ...Geckos grow new ones. It's fine."
- "I drew you something already. I'll give it to you after. It's a surprise. It's you."
- Back for the holidays: "School's OUT! I counted the days. It was a lot of days."
- Last meal was great: "The mochi last time was SO good. I told my whole class. My teacher wants some."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time it was a little bit black. That's okay! My mum burns stuff too."

Ordering conversation A

Clover: "Can I have the green mochi? Because I'm green! And it's green! We match!"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Of course. Green mochi for a green friend."	"YAY! Thank you! ...Please! I mean please."	+0.05
Playful	"Hmm. Are you sure you're not a mochi?"	Giggles. "I'm not a MOCHI! ...Am I?"	+0.05
Straight	"One mochi, coming up."	"Okay! Thank you!"	0
Rude	"Sit down properly."	Eyes go big. "...okay." She sits very still.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (questions)

Clover: "Why is the stove hot? Does it hurt it? Can I touch it? I won't touch it. Can I look at it?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"It's hot so it can cook your food. You can watch from the window."	"WHOA. Okay. I'm gonna watch the whole time."	+0.05
Playful	"The stove's just grumpy. It needs a hug, but don't give it one."	"A grumpy stove! Ha! I won't hug it. Promise."	+0.05
Straight	"It's hot so it can cook. What would you like?"	"Oh! Mochi, please!"	0
Rude	"Too many questions."	"...sorry." She stops asking for the rest of the visit.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (being a chef)

Clover: "When I grow up I'm gonna be a chef. Like you! Is it hard?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Sometimes. But you'd be a great chef."	Gasps. "Really? Okay. I'm gonna be the BEST one. After you."	+0.05
Playful	"Very hard. You have to taste everything. All day."	"That's not hard! That's the best job!"	+0.05
Straight	"It's a lot of work."	"I can do work! I do homework."	0
Rude	"You'd never manage it."	Her face falls. "...oh."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Banana milk, please! The yellow one!"
- Banana Milk not unlocked yet: "Do you have banana milk? No? ...Hot chocolate! With marshmallows! You don't have marshmallows. That's okay!"
- Other: "Something sweet! Not coffee. Coffee's yucky."

Serving

- Perfect: "WHOAAA. It's SO pretty. I don't wanna eat it. ...I'm gonna eat it."
- Great: "Yummy! Thank you!"
- Okay: "Thank you!" She eats it all and licks the plate.
- Burnt: "It's a little bit crunchy. That's okay! I like crunchy!"

Eating chats

- "Do you have a dog? I want a dog. My mum says no. Do YOU have a dog?"
- "I'm drawing you right now. Don't move. ...Okay, you can move. I'll make it up."
- "Why does that customer have so many patches? ...Oh, they're nice. I like them." (If Stitches is in.)
- "The big crocodile is my friend now! His name is Kyle! He's not scary. He's nice. He likes soup."
- "How many dishes have you washed? Like, ever? A hundred? A MILLION?"

Eating chat with choices

Clover: "Can I help? I'm really good at helping. I helped my grandma make cookies once. I only ate some."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"You can be my official taste-tester today."	"YESSS. I'm the official taste-tester! I need a badge!"	+0.05
Playful	"Only if you can reach the counter."	She stands on tiptoes. "...I'll grow!"	+0.05
Straight	"Not right now, but thank you."	"Okay! Maybe when I'm nine."	0
Rude	"Kids aren't allowed back there. Stay put."	"...okay." She colours quietly.	-0.05

Special: drawings

When Clover leaves, she leaves a crayon drawing on the table. Picking it up when clearing adds it to the Collections as a keepsake (one per visit, drawn in different styles):

- A chef with a giant hat and a very tall stove.

- The whole restaurant with everyone smiling, even the bins.
- Kyle the Crocodile holding her hand, labelled "MY FRIEND KYLE".
- "[name] THE BEST CHEF" in big wobbly letters.

Leaving

- "Bye bye! I left you a drawing! Don't look until I'm gone! ...You can look now."
- "Thank you! I'm gonna come back tomorrow! If my mum says yes!"
- "Bye, [name]! Bye, stove! Bye, booth!"
- Last visit of the holidays: "School starts tomorrow. I don't wanna go. Will you still be here? ...Okay. Promise?"

Seasons and holidays

- Spring break: "It's spring break! I found three worms! I didn't bring them. My mum said no."
- Summer: "It's SUMMER! I'm here for ALL of summer! Every day! Maybe!"
- Halloween: "I'm a dinosaur! RAWR! ...Did I scare you? Say I scared you."
- Christmas: "I made you a card! It has glitter! It's gonna get everywhere. Sorry."
- Chef's birthday: "It's your BIRTHDAY? How old are you? A hundred?"

With friends

- With Kyle: Clover: "This is Kyle! He's my best friend!" Kyle (gently, awkward): "I'm... yes. Hello. She drew me a picture. I have it on my fridge."
- With Kyle: "Kyle knows EVERYTHING. He knows why the sky is blue. I forgot why. He's gonna tell me again."
- First time she sees Kyle (before they're friends): She hides behind the booth. "...Is he gonna eat me?" Kyle, softly: "No. I'm having the soup."
- You've been kind to Kyle: "Kyle said you're nice to him! Good! Everyone should be nice to Kyle!"
- You've been rude to Kyle: "Kyle said you said "[last_rude_line]". That's mean! Say sorry!"

Juno the Otter

Juno is an eager, hardworking, slightly clumsy otter in college who's home for the summer and holidays, and always asking if you're hiring. She juggles anything she's holding and drops it half the time. Once staff unlock, she's one of the helpers you can hire.

Who Juno is

Look. A sleek brown otter with a big smile, a college hoodie, a backpack covered in pins, and a messy bun. Always has something in her paws: keys, a pen, a lemon.

Personality. Eager, hardworking and upbeat. A bit clumsy. She'll try anything and doesn't let a dropped tray slow her down. Constantly asks for a job. Learning to bake on Sundays with Hazel.

Core truth. Juno wants to be useful more than anything. Every "no" just makes her try harder.

Tendencies

- Juggles whatever's in her paws (salt shakers, lemons, her keys) and drops it about half the time.
- Asks "Are you hiring?" almost every visit, in a new way each time.
- Sits at the bar so she can watch the kitchen and "learn."
- Offers to clear her own plate, and occasionally other people's.
- Brings up whatever she's studying this semester.

Voice. Upbeat, quick, lots of "Oh!" and "Oops!". Optimistic about everything. Apologises cheerfully, not anxiously.

Favourite dish	Pork Dumplings
Favourite drink	Koala-Cola
Seating	Bar
In town	Comes and goes (home for summer and holidays)
Pairs	Hazel
Role	One of the hireable helpers once staff unlock

How your choices land. Warm and playful both land. Rude stings, but she bounces back fast ("Okay! Noted! I'll do better!"), which makes it feel worse.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Hi! I'm Juno! Oh, this place is so cool. Are you hiring? Sorry. Hi first. What's your name? [name]! Hi, [name]! Are you hiring?"
- "[name]! Hi! I'm back! Did you miss me? I missed this place!"
- "Oops!" She drops her keys on the way in. "I'm fine! Everything's fine!"
- "Bar seat? I like watching the kitchen. I'm learning. By watching. That counts, right?"
- Back for the summer: "Summer break! Three whole months! Do you need help? I'm free for three whole months!"
- Last meal was great: "Your dumplings last time? I tried to make them at home. I set off the smoke alarm. Yours are better."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little crispy! I'm not judging. I literally set things on fire weekly."

Ordering conversation A (the job)

Juno: "So, totally unrelated, but are you hiring? I can wash dishes. I can chop. I can... mostly chop."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Not yet, but you'll be first on my list."	"FIRST? Okay. Okay! I'm going to be so ready. Dumplings, please!"	+0.05
Playful	"Can you juggle plates?"	"Yes!" She tries with two salt shakers. Drops both. "...Not yet!"	+0.05
Straight	"Not right now. What can I get you?"	"That's okay! Dumplings, please."	0
Rude	"I'd never hire you."	"Oh! Okay! Noted!" She smiles a bit too hard. "Dumplings."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (college)

Juno: "I have an exam on marine biology next week. I'm an otter. You'd think I'd know this stuff already."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"You're going to do great. You work so hard."	"You think so? Okay. I'm putting that in my brain for exam day."	+0.05
Playful	"Just tell them you're a professional otter."	"Ha! 'Field experience.' I'm writing that on the test."	+0.05
Straight	"Good luck. What are you having?"	"Thanks! Dumplings, please!"	0
Rude	"Sounds like you'll fail."	"Ha! Maybe!" She laughs it off, but she's quiet after.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (helping)

Juno: "I noticed table two has a spill. Want me to get it? I'm already standing. I mean, I'm sitting. But I could stand."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"That's so kind. I've got it, but thank you."	"Okay! But if you ever need a hand, I've got two!"	+0.05
Playful	"Careful, or I'll start charging you rent for that stool."	"I'd pay it! In dish washing!"	+0.05
Straight	"I've got it. What can I get you?"	"Dumplings! Please!"	0
Rude	"Mind your own business."	"Oh. Right. Sorry!" She sits on her paws.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Koala-Cola, please! Student budget. Also it's delicious."
- Other: "Whatever's cheapest! Kidding. Kind of."

Serving

- Perfect: "WHOA. How do you DO that? Teach me. Please. I'll pay you. In enthusiasm."
- Great: "Yesss, dumplings! Thank you!"
- Okay: "Thank you! These are great!"
- Burnt: "Ooh, extra crispy! That's how I make them every time. Accidentally."

Eating chats

- She's juggling three dumplings. One lands in her mouth. "I MEANT to do that."
- "Hazel's teaching me to bake on Sundays. I've only set one thing on fire. ...Two."
- "My roommate thinks I'm weird for eating here every day. I think my roommate's never had your dumplings."
- "I'm watching how you plate things. For research. Pretend I'm not here."
- "Do you need anyone to taste-test anything? I'm available. Constantly."

Eating chat with choices

Juno: "Can I ask you something? How did you learn to cook? Like, how did you get good?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Lots of mistakes. You're already doing it right."	"Mistakes I can do! I'm an expert at mistakes!"	+0.05
Playful	"I was born holding a spatula."	"That's so painful for your mum. Ha!"	+0.05
Straight	"Practice."	"Practice. Okay. Writing that down."	0
Rude	"Some people just have it. You don't."	"Oh. Okay. I'll just... practice more, then."	-0.05

Special: always asking if you're hiring

Until staff unlock, Juno's arrival or leaving line often asks for a job, a little differently each time:

- "Are you hiring? Asking for a friend. The friend is me."
- "I made a CV. It's one page. It's mostly a drawing of a dumpling."

- "If you ever need someone to wash dishes, I'm very good at getting wet. Otter."
- Once staff unlock: "Wait. You're HIRING now? [name]. Look at me. LOOK at me."
- Hired as a helper: "I won't let you down! I'll try not to drop anything! I'll try REALLY hard!" (As a helper she occasionally drops a plate, says "Oops! I'm fine!", and picks it up.)

Leaving

- "Bye, [name]! Thanks for the food! And the life lessons!"
- "I'm gonna go study. Or nap. Probably nap."
- "See you tomorrow! If I'm not working. I'm never working. See you tomorrow!"
- Last visit before college: "Back to college tomorrow. I'll miss this place so much. Save me a bar stool?"

Seasons and holidays

- Summer: "Summer! I'm home! I have nothing to do except eat here and ask for a job!"
- Autumn: "School's starting soon. I'm going to miss the dumplings more than my family. Don't tell them."
- Winter: "Home for the holidays! I brought you something. It's a mug from my college. It's a bit chipped. I dropped it."
- Halloween: "I'm a chef! See? ...It's your outfit. Is that weird? That's a little weird."
- New Year: "My resolution is to drop things less. Starting... now." She drops her napkin.

With friends

- With Hazel: Hazel: "Juno's learning to bake with me on Sundays." Juno: "I've only set one thing on fire!" Hazel: "Two, dear."
- With Hazel: Juno knocks over the sugar. Hazel, without looking up from her knitting: "Dustpan's under the sink, sweetheart." Juno: "On it!"
- With Hazel: "Hazel says I have 'good instincts and terrible hands.' I'm taking it as a compliment."
- You've been kind to Hazel: "Hazel says you're a lovely young chef. She says that about me too, but she means it more about you."
- You've been rude to Hazel: "Hazel told me you said "[last_rude_line]". ...She's the sweetest person alive, [name]. Come on."

Luna the Owl

Luna is a sleepy, dreamy artist owl who always comes in tired, always orders coffee, and is wide awake at night. She sketches the restaurant while she eats, and every season she paints a new mural on its wall.

Who Luna is

Look. A soft grey owl with huge, heavy-lidded eyes, paint on her feathers, an oversized knitted sweater, and a sketchbook tucked under one wing. Charcoal smudges on her face she never notices.

Personality. Sleepy, dreamy and gentle. She's a night owl: half-asleep at lunch, sharp and chatty after dark. She sees beauty in small things and draws everything. Quietly funny in a dry, drowsy way.

Core truth. Luna sees the restaurant the way an artist does: the warm light, the steam, the faces. She paints it so everyone else can see it too.

Tendencies

- Yawns mid-sentence, especially before evening.
- Orders coffee every single visit, no exceptions.
- Sketches the room, the customers and the chefs while she waits.
- Visits mostly at dinner and during the night shift. Rarely at breakfast; if she does, she's barely conscious.
- Sits in a booth, curled up in the corner of it.

Voice. Slow and drowsy in the daytime ("Mmm." "...What?" "Coffee."). Warmer, dreamier and more talkative at night.

Favourite dish	Hotteok
Favourite drink	Coffee (always)
Seating	Booth
In town	Always (mostly dinner and night shift)
Pairs	Penny

Special fields	`state.mural_season`

How your choices land. Warm and playful both land. In the daytime, playful sometimes goes past her ("...Huh?", 0). Rude gets a slow blink and "Wow. Okay. I'm too tired for that."

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever (evening): "Hi. I'm Luna. ...I'm awake now. Barely. Do you have coffee? Please say yes. What's your name? [name]. I'll draw you sometime."
- Daytime: "Mmm. Hi. Coffee. ...Hi, [name]."
- Evening: "Evening, [name]. This is my morning. Don't laugh."
- Night shift: "Oh, it's quiet. I love it when it's quiet. Is the booth free?"
- Breakfast (rare): She walks in with her eyes closed and sits down. "...Coffee."
- Last meal was great: "I painted your hotteok last week. It's the best thing I've painted. Sorry, it's mostly the hotteok's fault."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little dark. Very moody. I drew it anyway."

Ordering conversation A

Luna: "Coffee first. Then food. Then thoughts."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Coffee's already brewing. I saw you coming."	Opens her eyes fully for the first time. "...You're an angel. Hotteok, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Should I just hook you up to the coffee machine?"	Night: "Please. Directly." Day: "...Huh?"	+0.05 / 0
Straight	"Coffee and what else?"	"Hotteok. Please. Thank you. Coffee."	0
Rude	"You look terrible."	Slow blink. "Wow. Okay. I'm too tired for that."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (her sketchbook)

Luna: "Can I draw you while I wait? Just keep doing what you're doing. Pretend I'm not here."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I'd be honoured."	Smiles sleepily. "Good. You have a nice face for drawing. Very... round. Hotteok, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Only if you draw me taller."	"I'll draw you as a giant. Cooking for tiny people."	+0.05
Straight	"Sure. What can I get you?"	"Hotteok. And coffee."	0
Rude	"Please don't."	"...Okay." She closes the sketchbook.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (night)

Luna (night shift only): "Everyone's asleep. This is the best time. Everything's softer at night. Even the lights."

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"I'm glad you're here to share it."	"Me too. ...That was very honest of me. It's late. Hotteok, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Some of us have to wake up at 5 AM, you know."	"Not me. Never me. Couldn't be me."	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"Hotteok and coffee. Night coffee."	0
Rude	"Go home and sleep."	"I just woke up." She turns to the window.	-0.05

Drink order

- Always: "Coffee." / "Coffee, please." / "Coffee. A big one." / Night: "Night coffee. It's the same coffee. It feels different."

Serving

- Perfect: "Oh. The steam's catching the light. Don't move it. I'm drawing it first."
- Great: "Mmm. Thank you, [name]."
- Okay: "Thanks. Looks good."
- Burnt: "Very dark. Very dramatic. I like it as art. Less as food."

Eating chats

- She's drawing. You see a sketch of the dining room, with you in it.
- Daytime: "Mm. Sorry. Napping with my eyes open. It's a skill."
- "The light hits the kitchen counter at exactly 7 PM. I come in for it. And the hotteok."
- "Penny's writing a story. I'm doing the pictures. Don't tell her I told you. She'll go pink."
- Night: "Do you ever look at the restaurant at night, with the chairs up? It looks like it's resting. Like it worked hard too."

Eating chat with choices

Luna: "I'm trying to decide what to paint for the next mural. What do you think this place feels like?"

Tone	You say	She says	Mood
Warm	"Like home."	Long pause. "...Yeah. That's what I'll paint."	+0.05
Playful	"Like a very busy kitchen run by one tired chef."	Laughs softly. "Self-portrait. Got it."	+0.05
Straight	"Cosy, I guess."	"Cosy. Okay. I can do cosy."	0
Rude	"Paint whatever. I don't care."	"...Okay." She doesn't sketch for the rest of the visit.	-0.05

Special: the seasonal mural

At the start of each season, Luna paints a new mural on one wall of the restaurant. It counts as decor for the star rating.

- The visit before: "I'm painting tonight. After you close. Don't peek."

- The day it appears: "Do you like it? I did it by moonlight. That's why the colours are a bit weird. On purpose."
- Spring: cherry blossoms over the restaurant's front door.
- Summer: the pond at sunset with the three docks.
- Autumn: the regulars and semi-regulars at a long table, painted small.
- Winter: the restaurant at night, snowy, every window glowing.

Leaving

- Daytime: "Okay. Bed. I mean, home. I mean bed."
- Night: "Thanks, [name]. I'm going to go paint until sunrise."
- "Bye. I'll bring you the sketch when it's finished. Probably. Eventually."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Spring light is so soft. I barely need to try."
- Summer: "The nights are too short. I resent the sun."
- Autumn: "Longer nights. Finally. Autumn is an owl's season."
- Winter: "It gets dark at 4 PM. Best time of year. I'm thriving."
- Halloween: "I'm a vampire. I mean, I'm always up at night. It's not really a costume."
- Christmas: "I drew you. Framed and everything. Hang it somewhere. Or don't. …Hang it." (Wall decor.)

With friends

- With Penny: Penny: "Luna draws while I read. We don't talk much." Luna (yawning): "It's the best friendship I've ever had."
- With Penny: Penny reads a line aloud. Luna sketches it. Neither says anything. They both look very happy.
- You've been kind to Penny: "Penny said you asked about her book. She glowed for an hour. Thank you."
- You've been rude to Penny: "Penny told me you said "[last_rude_line]". …She didn't read for a whole day. Be nice to her."
- About Yaniv (both night owls): "Yaniv is always here at 2 AM too. He talks a lot. It's a nice background noise."

Hezzy the Hedgehog

Hezzy is a straight-faced hedgehog who seems serious, quiet and a little prickly, until he suddenly bursts into song or makes a noise nobody would ever expect from him. Once he knows you, he's one of the funniest and most loyal characters in town.

Who Hezzy is

Look. A medium-sized brown hedgehog with tidy spines, a plain t-shirt and a calm, neutral face. Looks like the most serious person in the room.

Personality. Straight-faced and reserved with people he doesn't know. Very funny and fiercely loyal once he does. Does wacky things out of nowhere: sings a line from a made-up song, makes a weird honk, a whale noise, a dial-up modem sound, then goes straight back to normal like nothing happened.

Core truth. Hezzy's serious face is just his resting face. Inside, he's having the best time, and the random noises are how it escapes.

Tendencies

- Says very little on his first few visits, all of it politely.
- Once familiar, randomly bursts into song or makes an unexpected sound, then carries on as if nothing happened.
- Sits at a regular table and keeps his posture very straight.
- Never acknowledges his own outbursts. If you ask, he says "What?"
- Remembers if you were kind to his friends, and is very protective of them.

Voice. Before familiar: short, dry, polite. Once familiar: still deadpan, but with surprising jokes, a dry wit, and random noises written as sound effects (*honk*, *bwaaa*, a sung line).

Favourite dish	Apple Strudel
Favourite drink	Dr Salt
Seating	Table
In town	Always
Pairs	Violet

Warm-up	`familiar_after`: 5 visits

How your choices land. Straight always works with him (+0.05). Before familiar, playful gets a polite nod (0); once familiar, it gets a random noise of approval (+0.05). Rude: "Hm." He remembers it, and so does Violet.

Dialogue

Arrival (before familiar)

- First visit ever: "Hi. Hezzy. Table for one. ...Your name? [name]. Okay. Thanks."
- "Hello."
- "Table, please."
- "Hi again. It's good here."

Arrival (once familiar)

- The visit he becomes familiar: He sits down, looks at you seriously, and sings one dramatic line: "♪ I'm here for the strudel ♪". Then, completely normal: "Hi, [name]."
- "Hey, [name]." *Long, quiet honk.* "...Table, please."
- "Good to see you." He means it. You can tell because he nods twice.
- He walks in making a quiet whale noise, stops at the host stand. "Hi."
- Last meal was great: "Your strudel last time. I've been thinking about it." *Bwaaa.* "A lot."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was burnt. I'm not mad. I'm just remembering."

Ordering conversation A

Hezzy: "Strudel, please."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Coming right up. Always good to see you."	Before: "Thanks." Once familiar: "♪ Always good to see you too ♪". Then silence.	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Playful	"Just strudel? No speech, no song?"	Before: A polite nod. Once familiar: He takes a deep breath. Then just: "Strudel."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"One strudel."	"Yes."	+0.05
Rude	"You're very boring, you know that?"	"Hm."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B

Hezzy: "Is the Dr Salt cold today?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I'll get you the coldest one in the fridge."	Before: "Thank you." Once familiar: "You're a good person, [name]." Then, quietly: *ding*.	+0.05
Playful	"It's so cold it has its own weather."	Before: "Ha. Okay." Once familiar: A low, impressed whistle.	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Yes."	"Good. Strudel too."	+0.05
Rude	"It's a fridge. Obviously."	"Right."	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (once familiar only)

Hezzy: "I've been working on a new noise. Want to hear it?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Absolutely. I'm honoured."	He makes the strangest noise you've ever heard (a dial-up modem, a kettle, a goose). Then: "Strudel, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Only if I can rate it out of ten."	He does it. "Score?" Whatever you'd say, he nods. "Fair."	+0.05
Straight	"Maybe after your order."	"Fair. Strudel." He does it on the way out instead.	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Rude	"Please don't."	"Okay." He looks very slightly sad.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Dr Salt. Cold."
- Dr Salt not unlocked yet: "No Dr Salt? Hm. Koala-Cola."
- Other: "Whatever's cold."

Serving

- Perfect: Before: "...That's very good." Once familiar: He stands up, sings one triumphant note, sits back down. "Thank you."
- Great: "Looks good. Thanks."
- Okay: "Thanks."
- Burnt: "Burnt." Once familiar: *sad trombone noise.* "I'll eat it."

Eating chats

- Before familiar: "It's good. Thanks."
- Before familiar: "Nice place."
- Once familiar: "I sang in the shower for two hours this morning. My neighbour knocked. He wanted a song too."
- Once familiar: He's eating in complete silence. Then, without looking up: *honk*. Then nothing.
- Once familiar: "People think I'm serious. I'm not. I'm just tired of my face asking."

Eating chat with choices

Hezzy: "Can I ask you something? Do I look like I'm having a good time?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Honestly? I can tell you are."	"Good. Because I am." *Little happy whistle.*	+0.05
Playful	"You look like you're doing taxes."	Before: "...Fair." Once familiar: He laughs out loud for the first time. It's a honk.	0 / +0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Straight	"Not really."	"Yeah. I am, though."	+0.05
Rude	"You look like you hate everything."	"Hm. I don't."	-0.05

Special: surprise outbursts

Once familiar, Hezzy has about a 1-in-3 chance per visit of a random outburst: a short sung line or a sound effect, at a random moment (arrival, eating or leaving). Nearby customers turn their heads. Hezzy carries on as if nothing happened. If you click him straight after, he says "What?"

Outburst pool: a sung line ("♪ Strudel in my heart ♪"), a goose honk, a whale call, a dial-up modem, a kettle whistle, a single dramatic opera note, a beatbox. The surprise emote is rare enough that it always catches players off guard.

Leaving

- Before familiar: "Thanks. Bye."
- Once familiar: "See you, [name]." On his way out the door: "♪ Goodbye, restaurant ♪".
- Once familiar: "Good food. Good people." Nods twice. Leaves.

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Birds are singing." Pause. "Competition."
- Summer: "Too hot for spines."
- Winter: "I'm wearing a scarf. Hazel made it. Don't tell anyone it's pink."
- Halloween: "I'm a cactus." He is just a hedgehog. "Very convincing."
- Christmas: He sings an entire carol at the host stand, solemnly, then orders.

With friends

- With Violet: They sit together in complete silence. Then Hezzy suddenly bursts into song. Violet: "Ok."
- With Violet: Hezzy makes a weird honking noise out of nowhere. Violet, without looking up: "Haha, nice."
- With Violet: "Violet doesn't talk much. I sing. It balances out."

- You've been kind to Violet: "Violet said you're nice. She said it with three words. That's a lot for her."
- You've been rude to Violet: "Violet said you said "[last_rude_line]"." Long pause. "Don't." (No noise. He's completely serious.)

Kyle the Crocodile

Kyle is a huge, tall, scary-looking crocodile, and the gentlest, most awkward person in town. Everyone assumes he'll be mean; he's shy, very smart, wears glasses, and has a great sense of humour. Be kind to him and he opens up fast, though he'll always be a little awkward, even with his closest friends.

Who Kyle is

Look. A very large, tall dark-green crocodile with a long snout full of teeth, tiny round glasses perched on top, and a cardigan or sweater vest. Hunches a little to seem smaller. Holds his mug with both claws.

Personality. Shy, awkward and very smart. Reads a lot, knows strange facts, and has a quick, dry sense of humour once he's comfortable. If you're kind to him, he warms up quickly. He always stays a bit awkward, even with friends. Chompy's cousin: the dim alligator and the smart croc. Different from Stitches: Stitches is nervous and hopeful; Kyle is nerdy-awkward with quick wit.

Core truth. Kyle has spent his whole life being judged by his teeth. Kindness that doesn't flinch means everything to him.

Tendencies

- Ducks through the doorway even though he doesn't need to.
- Apologises for taking up space at the booth.
- Shares an odd, interesting fact almost every visit.
- Pushes his glasses up his snout when he's nervous.
- Orders vegetable soup, which surprises everyone. (He's basically vegetarian.)

Voice. Soft, careful, a little halting at first ("Um," "I mean," "Sorry, that's—"). Once he's warmed up to a chef: dry jokes, precise words, then a nervous laugh at himself.

Favourite dish	Hearty Vegetable Soup
Favourite drink	Hot Chocolate
Seating	Booth
In town	Always

Pairs	Chompy (cousin), Clover
Warm-up	Opens up after 2 warm choices from the same chef

How your choices land. Warm is his favourite. Playful lands once he's opened up to that chef; before that it's a nervous laugh (0). Rude: he goes quiet and hurt for that visit, and his next visit starts more awkward than usual.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: Nearby customers look nervous as he ducks in. Your chat choices include a nervous one ("Uh... table for... one, sir?"). Kyle, in the softest voice: "Oh. Um. Yes, please. Sorry. I'm Kyle. I know I look... I'm very gentle. What's your name? [name]. Nice to meet you, [name]."
- "Hi, [name]. Um. Is the booth free? I fit better in the booth."
- "Hello. Sorry. Hi." He pushes up his glasses.
- "I read on the way here and walked into a lamppost. The lamppost is fine."
- Opened up: "[name]! Hi. I mean. Hi. I was looking forward to this. Is that weird? That's fine."
- Last meal was great: "Your soup last time was, um, statistically the best soup I've had. I've had a lot of soup."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little... charred. It's okay. Char has antioxidants. Probably."
- After you were rude last time: "Um. Hi." He doesn't make eye contact.

Ordering conversation A

Kyle: "Could I get the vegetable soup? People always expect me to order something... with teeth in it."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Soup's a great choice. I'll make it extra hearty for you."	"Oh. Thank you. That's... really nice." He relaxes his shoulders.	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Playful	"I'll keep the teeth out of it, promise."	Before opening up: A nervous laugh. Opened up: "Thank you. I have enough of my own."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"One vegetable soup."	"Yes, please. Thank you."	0
Rude	"Bit of a weird order for a croc."	"...Yeah. I know." He shrinks into the booth.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (a fact)

Kyle: "Did you know crocodiles can't stick out their tongues? Sorry. I just think about that a lot."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I didn't know that! Tell me more facts anytime."	"Really? Okay. I have... a lot. I'll ration them."	+0.05
Playful	"That explains why you never make faces at me."	Before: A nervous laugh. Opened up: He tries. He can't. "See? Tragic."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Interesting. What can I get you?"	"The soup, please. And hot chocolate."	0
Rude	"Nobody asked."	"Right. Sorry." He doesn't share another fact this visit.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (his size)

Kyle: "Sorry. I know I take up a lot of the booth."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"The booth's yours. Take all the space you need."	Long pause. "...Nobody says that."	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Playful	"That's why we built it. Kyle-sized."	Before: "Oh. Ha." Opened up: "Kyle-sized. I'll put that on my tombstone."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"You're fine. What can I get you?"	"The soup, please."	0
Rude	"Yeah, you kind of do."	"...Sorry." He hunches even smaller.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Hot chocolate, please. With... if you have... no, that's fine. Just hot chocolate."
- Other: "Something warm, please. I get cold. Cold-blooded. Ha. Sorry."

Serving

- Perfect: "Oh. Oh, wow. That's... that's really beautiful. Thank you."
- Great: "Thank you so much, [name]."
- Okay: "Thank you. It smells nice."
- Burnt: "It's okay. Really. I'll eat it. It's good. Thank you." He eats every bite.

Eating chats

- "Did you know the word 'soup' comes from an old word for bread soaked in broth? Sorry. I'll stop."
- "Chompy's my cousin. He's... not a reader. He's very happy, though. I'm a little jealous."
- "A little gecko girl hid from me last week. I don't blame her. I'd hide from me." (Before Clover befriends him.)
- Opened up: "I'm reading three books at once right now. It's a problem. A good problem."
- Opened up: "I don't usually talk this much. You're easy to talk to. Sorry. That was a lot."

Eating chat with choices

Kyle: "Can I ask you something? Do I seem scary to you?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Not even a little. You're one of the kindest people who comes in here."	He takes his glasses off and wipes them for a long time. "...Thank you, [name]."	+0.05
Playful	"Only when you tell me facts before I've had coffee."	Before: A nervous laugh. Opened up: "That's fair. They're very scary facts."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"You did at first. Not anymore."	"That's... honest. I'll take that."	0
Rude	"Kind of, yeah."	"...Right." He finishes his soup quickly and quietly.	-0.05

Special: the first meeting

Kyle's first-ever arrival plays a special moment: two or three nearby customers do a nervous emote and lean away as he ducks through the door. The chef's greeting choices are all nervous ("Uh... table for... one, sir?", "H-hello there!", "Welcome! Please don't eat me."). He answers each one softly and awkwardly, and from then on the other customers don't react.

Special: opening up

After 2 warm choices from the same chef, Kyle opens up to that chef: his voice gets a bit more confident, playful choices land, and he starts telling jokes. A rude choice resets the count to 0 for that chef.

Leaving

- "Thank you, [name]. I'll, um. See you. Bye."
- "That was really nice. The soup. And talking. Both." He waves awkwardly and bumps the door frame.
- Opened up: "See you next time. I'll bring a new fact. A good one."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Spring. Lots of pollen. My glasses get very yellow."
- Summer: "I love summer. Cold-blooded. This is the only time I feel awake."

- Winter: "It's very cold. I'm wearing three sweater vests. Please don't count them."
- Halloween: "Everyone thinks I'm wearing a costume. I'm not. This is just me."
- Christmas: He gives you a book, carefully wrapped. "It's about the history of soup. I thought... you'd like it?"

With friends

- With Chompy: Chompy: "This is my cousin Kyle. He's smart. Like, book smart." Kyle: "I'm... it's nice to meet you. He's told me nothing about you. Which is normal for him."
- With Chompy: Chompy: "Kyle, how many teeth do we have?" Kyle: "About sixty-six." Chompy: "...I have one."
- With Clover: Clover: "This is Kyle! He's my best friend!" Kyle (gently, awkward): "I'm... yes. Hello. She drew me a picture. I have it on my fridge."
- You've been kind to Clover: "Clover says you let her be the taste-tester. That made her whole week. Mine too, a little."
- You've been rude to Chompy: "Chompy told me you said "[last_rude_line]". He didn't understand it. I did. Please don't."

Yaniv the Yak

Yaniv is a big, loud, bearded yak with a story for everything. He works in sales, so he can talk to anyone about anything, stays up all night gaming, and holds court at the bar like it's his own show. He's away on sales trips a lot, and comes back with even bigger stories.

Who Yaniv is

Look. A big, shaggy brown yak. His long shaggy hair doubles as a full beard. Wears a slightly rumpled button-up with the sleeves rolled, a lanyard from his last sales conference, and a gaming headset around his neck at night.

Personality. Loud, confident and endlessly chatty. Always has a story, and every story has a twist. Works in sales, so he's naturally great with people and could sell you your own spatula. Loves video games and stays up all night. Talks about lucky streaks and card nights (no gambling in the game itself). Generous and warm under the noise.

Core truth. Yaniv loves people. Every story is really an excuse to spend more time with whoever's listening.

Tendencies

- Talks to everyone at the bar, including people who didn't ask.
- Tells long stories in parts across visits (`state.story_part`), always ending on a cliffhanger.
- Visits mostly at dinner and during the night shift.
- Pitches things to you like a salesman ("Picture this: a yak-sized portion.").
- Away on sales trips now and then; comes back with conference lanyards and stories.

Voice. Big, booming, energetic. "Okay, okay, okay, listen.", "So picture this.", "No, no, wait, it gets better." Sales-y phrases used for everything.

Favourite dish	Fire Noodles
Favourite drink	Moose-tain Dew
Seating	Bar
In town	Comes and goes (sales trips)
Pairs	Cody; Zakk (regular)

Special fields	`state.story_part`, `[story]`

How your choices land. Warm and playful both land; he loves a good back-and-forth. Straight is fine (he'll still tell the story). Rude: "Whoa, okay. Tough crowd tonight," and he turns to talk to someone else.

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "HEY! Big fan of the place already. Yaniv. Sales. Don't worry, I'm off the clock. Mostly. And you are? [name]! [name], my friend, we're going to get along great."
- "[name]! My favourite chef! Don't tell the other chefs. Actually, tell them. Healthy competition."
- "Bar seat? Perfect. Best seat in the house. Best audience."
- "I've been up since yesterday. Gaming marathon. I'm thriving. I think."
- Back from a sales trip: "I'M BACK. Three cities, two conferences, one very confusing hotel. Okay, sit down. Wait, you're working. Stand there and I'll tell you."
- Night shift: "Two AM and you're still open for calls? You and me, we're the same kind of people."
- Last meal was great: "Your fire noodles last time? I described them in a sales pitch. Closed the deal."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little toasty. I'm not complaining. I'm giving feedback. It's a sales thing."

Ordering conversation A

Yaniv: "Okay, okay, listen. Pitch me. Why should I order the fire noodles tonight?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Because I make them just the way you like them."	"Personal touch! That's how you close. Sold. Fire noodles."	+0.05
Playful	"Limited time offer. Only available tonight. And every night."	Booming laugh. "Urgency AND reliability! You should be in sales!"	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Straight	"They're good. Want them?"	"Simple. Direct. I respect it. Yes."	0
Rude	"I'm not doing a pitch. Just order."	"Whoa, okay. Tough crowd tonight." He orders and turns to the next customer.	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (the story)

Yaniv: "So remember where I left off? [story]. Okay, so THEN..."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I've been waiting all week for this. Go on."	Delighted, he tells the next part. Ends on a cliffhanger. "...And that's all you get today. Noodles, please."	+0.05
Playful	"Is this the one with the goat?"	"There's NO goat. ...There might be a goat later."	+0.05
Straight	"Tell me while I take your order."	"Multitasking! Okay, so..." He tells it fast. "Noodles."	0
Rude	"I don't care how it ends."	"Ouch. Okay. Noodles." He saves the story for someone else.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (lucky streak)

Yaniv: "Card night last night. I was on a streak. Five hands in a row. Then I lost to a tortoise. A tortoise, [name]."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Five in a row is still amazing."	"Thank you! See, you get it. Fire noodles."	+0.05
Playful	"Was it Olive? She's ruthless."	"It WAS Olive! How do you know? Is everyone losing to Olive?"	+0.05
Straight	"What can I get you?"	"Fire noodles. And a Moose-tain Dew."	0

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Rude	"Maybe you're just bad at cards."	"Wow. Okay. I'll take that to Olive."	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Moose-tain Dew. The official drink of staying up too late."
- Moose-tain Dew not unlocked yet: "No Moose-tain Dew? Coffee, then. Black. Like my sleep schedule."
- Other: "Whatever's got the most caffeine. Don't judge me."

Serving

- Perfect: "Okay. OKAY. Everybody look at this. This is what I'm talking about. Five stars. Ten stars."
- Great: "Now THAT'S a product I can sell."
- Okay: "Solid. Reliable. Good noodles."
- Burnt: "Little smoky! It's fine, I'll market it as 'flame-kissed.'"

Eating chats

- "So I'm at this conference, right, and the guy next to me is ALSO a yak. Same hair. We were like mirrors. Anyway."
- "I sold a fridge to a penguin last month. Hardest sale of my life. He kept saying 'I live in the cold.' I said 'Yes, but have you considered: drinks?'"
- "Cody and I gamed till sunrise last night. He's really good. Don't tell him I said that."
- Night shift: "It's quiet. I love it when it's quiet. More room for my voice."
- He's turned around on his stool and is telling a story to the customer behind him, who did not ask.

Eating chat with choices

Yaniv: "Real talk, [name]. Have you ever thought about expanding? Franchise? Yak-sized portions? I could sell this place in a heartbeat."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I like it small. But thanks for believing in it."	"Small and great. You know what, that's the better pitch."	+0.05
Playful	"You're hired. Head of yak-sized portions."	"I ACCEPT. When do I start? I'm starting now."	+0.05
Straight	"Not right now."	"Fair. The offer stands. Forever."	0
Rude	"I'm not interested in your pitch."	"Okay, okay. Message received." He goes quiet for the first time ever.	-0.05

Special: the running story

Yaniv tells one long story across visits, a part per visit (`state.story_part`), always ending on a cliffhanger. `[story]` is a one-line recap of where he left off. When a story ends, a new one starts.

- Story 1, "The Lost Luggage": his suitcase gets sent to the wrong city, then a different one, then turns up at the airport wearing someone else's luggage tag, with a goat inside. (There is a goat.)
- Story 2, "The Big Sale": he spends a week trying to sell a single fridge to a penguin.
- Story 3, "The All-Nighter": a gaming night with Cody so long that they both forget what day it is.

Leaving

- "That's a wrap! Great service, great food, great audience. Bye, [name]!"
- "Okay, I'm going home to game until the sun comes up. Don't tell my boss."
- "To be continued..." (After a story part.) "You'll have to come back. I mean, I'll come back. You're already here."
- Leaving on a sales trip: "Sales trip tomorrow. Three cities. If I don't come back, I've probably sold myself."

Seasons and holidays

- Summer: "Summer conference season. I'll be gone a lot. Miss me. Don't replace me."
- Winter: "It's cold. I'm a yak. This is my weather. I'm wearing a t-shirt."

- Halloween: "I'm a salesman." He is dressed exactly as usual. "The scariest costume of all."
- Christmas: "I got you a gift. It's a free subscription to my newsletter. There's no newsletter. I'll start one."
- New Year: "My resolution is to sleep. At night. Like a normal person. We'll see."

With friends

- With Cody: Yaniv: "This guy beat me at a racing game last night." Cody (slow, chill): "Every game." Yaniv: "MOST games."
- With Cody: Yaniv talks for five minutes straight. Cody says one word. Yaniv: "See? He gets me."
- About Zakk (regular): "Zakk's my guy. Me, Zakk and Cody, gaming trio. Undefeated. Except when we lose."
- You've been kind to Zakk: "Zakk says you look out for him. That's a good look, [name]. That's a great look."
- You've been rude to Cody: "Cody told me you said "[last_rude_line]". He shrugged it off. He shrugs everything off. Doesn't mean it didn't land."

Cody the Coyote

Cody is the most laid-back guy in town: a chill coyote whose perfect night is gaming or talking by a fire. He takes a long time to warm up, and he doesn't fake friendliness, but once he does, you're friends for life. He loves his car, and every few visits it's got something new.

Who Cody is

Look. A lean, sandy coyote with a relaxed slouch, a worn flannel or hoodie, and grease on his paws from working on his car. Car keys spinning on one finger.

Personality. Laid back and chill. Not unfriendly, just slow to let people in. A great night is sitting, playing video games, or talking by the fire. Loves cars, and loves telling you about the newest thing he added or a funny story about fixing it. Once he's your friend, he's loyal for life.

Core truth. Cody gives his trust slowly because he gives it completely.

Tendencies

- Parks his car out front, and it visibly changes over time (`state.car_level`).
- Sits on the patio, near the string lights.
- Says very little on early visits, and gets more talkative visit by visit.
- Sometimes found hanging out by the beach campfire or the back-garden lantern After Hours.
- Nods instead of saying hi.

Voice. Slow, low-key, short. "Yeah.", "Cool.", "Not bad." Once familiar: longer, easy-going stories, especially about his car, with dry humour.

Favourite dish	Honey Pancakes
Favourite drink	Gander Ale
Seating	Patio
In town	Always
Pairs	Yaniv; Zakk (regular)

Warm-up	`familiar_after`: 8 visits (slowest in town)
Special fields	`state.car_level`

How your choices land. Before familiar, warm and playful both get a calm "Cool." (+0.05 and 0). Once familiar, playful lands (+0.05). Rude: he shrugs it off outwardly, "Okay," but it sets his warm-up back by 2 visits.

Dialogue

Arrival (before familiar)

- First visit ever: A nod. "Hey. Cody. Patio open? ...Cool. What's your name? [name]. Cool."
- A nod. "Hey."
- "Patio, if it's open."
- "Not bad in here."

Arrival (once familiar)

- The visit he becomes familiar: "Hey, [name]. ...You know, I like coming here. Feels good. Anyway. Patio?"
- "[name]. What's up. You see the car? Go look at the car. I'll wait."
- "Yo. Long day. Pancakes are gonna fix it."
- "Good to see you, man." (He means it.)
- Last meal was great: "Your pancakes last time. I ate them slow on purpose. Didn't want them to end."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little black. All good. I'm used to burnt. You should see my exhaust."

Ordering conversation A

Cody: "Pancakes. Honey."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Coming up. Good to see you, Cody."	Before: "Cool. You too." Once familiar: "Always good to be here, [name]."	+0.05
Playful	"Want them stacked like a car jack?"	Before: "...Cool." Once familiar: A slow grin. "Now you're speaking my language."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Pancakes, honey. Got it."	"Thanks."	0
Rude	"You always order the same thing."	A shrug. "Okay."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (the car)

Cody: "Put new rims on the car this week."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I saw! They look amazing."	Before: "Thanks. Yeah." A small smile. Once familiar: "You NOTICED? Okay, let me tell you about these rims."	+0.05
Playful	"Does it go faster now, or just look faster?"	Before: "Looks faster." Once familiar: "Both. Mostly looks. Okay, just looks."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Nice. What can I get you?"	"Pancakes."	0
Rude	"Nobody cares about your car."	"I do." He looks out the window at it.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (once familiar only)

Cody: "You ever just sit by a fire and talk? No phone, no games. Just talk."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Not enough. Sounds perfect."	"Come down to the beach fire sometime after close. I'll be there."	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Playful	"I work next to a stove all day. I've had enough fire."	Laughs. "Fair. Okay, fair."	+0.05
Straight	"Sometimes. Pancakes?"	"Pancakes."	0
Rude	"Sounds boring."	"...Yeah. Maybe." He goes quiet.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Gander Ale. Cold."
- Gander Ale not unlocked yet: "No Gander Ale? Root Bear, I guess."
- Other: "Whatever's cold."

Serving

- Perfect: Before: "...That's really good." Once familiar: "Okay. That's the best stack I've ever seen. And I've seen a lot of stacks."
- Great: "Nice. Thanks."
- Okay: "Cool. Thanks."
- Burnt: "Little burnt. All good."

Eating chats

- Before familiar: He nods while chewing.
- Before familiar: "It's good."
- Once familiar: "I was fixing the car last night and the bumper just fell off. In my hands. I stood there holding a bumper for like five minutes."
- Once familiar: "Yaniv kept me up gaming till sunrise again. He talks the whole time. I just win."
- Once familiar: "This is a good spot. Patio, string lights, pancakes. Don't need much else."

Eating chat with choices

Cody: "Can I ask you something? You ever feel like you're doing too much?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"All the time. It's nice to have someone ask."	Before: A slow nod. "Take a break sometime." Once familiar: "Take a night off. Come to the fire. I mean it."	+0.05
Playful	"Only when Yaniv tells his stories."	Before: "...Ha." Once familiar: He laughs properly. "Same, man. Same."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Sometimes."	"Yeah."	0
Rude	"Mind your own business."	"Okay." He shrugs. (Warm-up set back.)	-0.05

Special: the car out front

Cody's car is parked at the curb whenever he visits. `state.car_level` goes up every 5 of his visits, and each level changes how it looks. On the first visit after a change, he tells you about it:

1. A plain, slightly rusty hatchback. "She's not much. Yet."
2. New rims. "Got rims. They're shiny. I polished them for an hour."
3. A spoiler. "Added a spoiler. Does it help? Nope. Does it look cool? Yep."
4. A fresh paint job. "Painted her. Took three tries. The first two were... a phase."
5. Under-glow lights. "Under-glow. Wait till it's dark. Then come look. I'll wait."
6. Fully done: "She's finished. Took me two years. ...Want a ride? Kidding. Kind of."

Funny fixing stories in between: the bumper falling off, locking his keys inside with the engine running, a family of birds nesting in the exhaust that he refused to move.

Special: the fire

Once familiar, Cody sometimes hangs out After Hours by the back-garden lantern, or by the beach campfire on Cheddar's trips. Talking to him there plays a quiet chat: "Good night for it." / "Sit. Stay a while." / "This is the life, [name]."

Leaving

- Before familiar: A nod. "See you."

- Once familiar: "Thanks, man. Good night."
- Once familiar: "Gonna go work on the car. Or sit in it. Probably sit in it."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Spring cleaning. For the car. Not the house."
- Summer: "Windows down weather. Best time of the year."
- Autumn: "Bonfire season. Finally."
- Winter: "Car won't start in the cold. I'm walking everywhere. It's tragic."
- Halloween: "I'm a mechanic." He is wearing his usual clothes, with extra grease.
- Christmas: "Got you an air freshener. For your car. You don't have a car? ...Hang it in the kitchen."

With friends

- With Yaniv: Yaniv: "This guy beat me at a racing game last night." Cody (slow, chill): "Every game." Yaniv: "MOST games."
- With Yaniv: Yaniv talks for five minutes straight. Cody says one word. Yaniv: "See? He gets me."
- About Zakk (regular): "Zakk's solid. Good guy. Doesn't talk too much. Unlike some people." (He glances at Yaniv.)
- You've been kind to Zakk: "Zakk says you're good people. That's enough for me."
- You've been rude to Yaniv: "Yaniv told me you said "[last_rude_line]". He acts like nothing gets to him. Stuff gets to him."

Brandon the Bison

Brandon is a big, calm, laid-back bison who seems quiet and straight at first, then turns into a playful tease once he knows you. He's obsessed with superheroes, movies and shows, and he always knows exactly how many days until the next one comes out.

Who Brandon is

Look. A big, broad brown bison with a shaggy mane and small horns, in a superhero t-shirt (a different hero every visit), a zip-up hoodie and comfy sneakers. Usually has a movie ticket stub poking out of his pocket.

Personality. Very calm and laid back. Straight and polite at first. Once he gets to know you, he becomes playful and starts teasing you with jokes. Loves superheroes, movies and shows, and is always excited for the next release. The town has its own made-up superhero franchises (no real Marvel or DC names).

Core truth. Brandon only teases people he likes. If he's teasing you, you've made it.

Tendencies

- Wears a different superhero shirt every visit.
- Counts down the days to the next big release out loud.
- Before familiar: polite and short. Once familiar: teases the chef about everything, gently.
- Sits in a booth, stretched out comfortably.
- Rates things like a movie critic ("Strong opening. Great third act.").

Voice. Calm, low, unhurried. Once familiar: dry teasing with a straight face, then a slow grin. Movie phrases for everything ("Plot twist.", "Sequel?", "Post-credits scene.").

Favourite dish	Soft Pretzel with cheese dip
Favourite drink	Pupsi
Seating	Booth
In town	Always
Pairs	Rush

Warm-up	`familiar_after`: 5 visits

How your choices land. Before familiar, playful gets a polite chuckle (0). Once familiar, playful is his favourite (+0.05): he'll tease you right back. Rude: "Hm. Okay," calmly, and he stops teasing you for that visit.

Dialogue

Arrival (before familiar)

- First visit ever: "Hey. Brandon. Booth, if you've got one. ...What's your name? [name]. Cool. Thanks."
- "Hey. Booth, please."
- "Hi. Nice place."
- "Hey. Movie later. Thought I'd eat first."

Arrival (once familiar)

- The visit he becomes familiar: "Hey, [name]. You know what this place needs? A sequel. ...I'm kidding. It's great. Okay, now I'm going to tease you forever."
- "[name]. Oh, you're still working here? Thought you'd been promoted to 'customer.'"
- "Three days until Captain Carrot 3. Three. Days."
- "Booth, please. My usual. You know the one. Don't pretend you don't."
- Last meal was great: "Your pretzel last time? Ten out of ten. Strong opening. Great cheese."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a bit burnt. Plot twist. I'll allow it once."

Ordering conversation A

Brandon: "Pretzel, please. With the cheese."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Extra cheese for you. Always."	Before: "Thanks." Once familiar: "Extra cheese? Okay, you're officially my favourite chef. Don't let it go to your head."	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Playful	"Popcorn's not on the menu, if you were wondering."	Before: A polite chuckle. Once familiar: "Popcorn would make you a cinema. You're not ready for that responsibility."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"One pretzel."	"Thanks."	0
Rude	"Same as always. Predictable."	"Hm. Okay."	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (the shirt)

Brandon: "You notice the shirt? Night Moose. First edition design."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Love it. Who's Night Moose?"	He lights up and explains the whole origin story. "...Anyway. Pretzel."	+0.05
Playful	"Is Night Moose the one with the antler cape?"	Before: "Ha. Close." Once familiar: "It's an ANTLER BOOMERANG. Did you even watch the movie? I'm disappointed in you."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Nice. What can I get you?"	"The [dish]."	0
Rude	"Aren't you a bit old for superheroes?"	Calmly: "Nope." He doesn't elaborate.	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (once familiar only)

Brandon: "Okay, real question. If you were a superhero, what would your power be?"

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Making people's day better, one plate at a time."	"...Okay, that was actually kind of good. I hate it. Pretzel."	+0.05
Playful	"Flipping pancakes with my mind."	"Captain Spatula. I'd watch that. Mid-budget. Cult classic."	+0.05
Straight	"I don't know. Flying?"	"Classic. Safe. Respectable."	0

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Rude	"That's a childish question."	"Hm. Okay." No more teasing this visit.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Pupsi. The official drink of movie night."
- Pupsi not unlocked yet: "No Pupsi? Koala-Cola, then. The knock-off. ...They're both knock-offs. Of each other."
- Other: "Something fizzy."

Serving

- Perfect: Before: "...Wow. Thanks." Once familiar: "Okay. Standing ovation. I'm not standing. But in my heart."
- Great: "Strong entry."
- Okay: "Solid. Middle of the franchise."
- Burnt: "Burnt. This is the sequel nobody asked for."

Eating chats

- Before familiar: "It's good. Thanks."
- Once familiar: "You know, for a chef, you're pretty good at this. That's a joke. You're great. Mostly."
- Once familiar: "Rush fell asleep halfway through the Captain Carrot marathon. He says he didn't. He snored through the final battle."
- Once familiar: "I've seen every Night Moose movie four times. The fourth one is bad. I've seen it six times."
- "The trailer for Captain Carrot 3 came out. I've watched it twelve times. There's a frame where you can see a carrot in the background. Huge."

Eating chat with choices

Brandon: "Captain Carrot 3 comes out this week. Midnight showing. You should come."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I'd love to. Save me a seat."	Before: "Cool. I will." Once familiar: "I'll save you a seat. I'll also judge how loud you eat popcorn."	+0.05
Playful	"Only if you don't explain every scene to me."	Before: "Ha. Fair." Once familiar: "No promises. I have notes."	0 / +0.05
Straight	"Can't. I close late."	"Fair. I'll tell you about it. In detail."	0
Rude	"I'd rather not."	"Hm. Okay."	-0.05

Special: the town's superheroes

Brandon's shirts and countdowns use made-up franchises, so no real names are needed:

- **Captain Carrot**: a rabbit hero with a carrot sword. Captain Carrot 3 is "coming soon" all year.
- **Night Moose**: a brooding moose vigilante with an antler boomerang.
- **The Incredible Hulkatoad**: a toad who gets big when he's angry.
- **Wonder Wombat**: "The best one. Don't argue."

Every couple of weeks, he announces a release countdown ("Ten days until Night Moose Returns."), and on release day: "It came out. I saw it twice. I'm not ready to talk about it."

Leaving

- Before familiar: "Thanks. See you."
- Once familiar: "Good stuff, [name]. Two thumbs up. Okay, one and a half."
- Once familiar: "Movie time. Don't wait up. You weren't going to. I know."

Seasons and holidays

- Summer: "Summer blockbuster season. Best time of year."
- Winter: "It's cold. Perfect excuse to stay in and rewatch everything."
- Halloween: "I'm Night Moose." (He is wearing antlers over his horns. Very serious.)
- Christmas: "Got you a superhero shirt. It's Captain Carrot. Wear it. I'll know if you don't."

- New Year: "My resolution is to watch less movies. ...Fewer movies. See? I'm already changing."

With friends

- With Rush: Rush: "This guy made me watch three superhero movies in a row." Brandon: "You loved it." Rush: "...I loved it."
- With Rush: Brandon teases Rush about being late. Rush says it back, but worse. They both laugh, and Rush's laugh starts the laugh chain.
- About Rush: "Rush is the only one I can't tease. He comes back too hard."
- You've been kind to Rush: "Rush says you're a real one. That's the highest honour he gives. Congrats."
- You've been rude to Rush: "Rush told me you said "[last_rude_line]". He won't say it hurt. I'm saying it for him."

Seth the White Retriever

Seth is a super sporty, super genuine white retriever with almost spooky intuition: once he likes you, he knows how you're feeling the moment you walk in. He's always rushing off to his next game, he means every word he says, and he takes things personally. Be rude to him and he won't forget, until you apologise.

Who Seth is

Look. A big, fluffy white retriever with bright, warm eyes and a wagging tail. Always in sports kit, a different one depending on the day: football jersey, baseball cap and glove, volleyball shorts. A gym bag over one shoulder.

Personality. Super sporty and super genuine. He means everything he says, the good and the bad. Unbelievable intuition: once you're friends, he senses how you're feeling straight away, sometimes before you even see each other. Takes things very personally; if you're mean to him, he never forgets. Always rushing off to his next game: football, baseball, volleyball.

Core truth. Seth feels everything deeply, his own feelings and everyone else's. That's what makes him such a good friend, and why rudeness cuts him so hard.

Tendencies

- Arrives in a rush, eats fast, and leaves for a game.
- Wears a different sport's kit depending on the day of the week.
- Notices how the chef, the restaurant or a regular is doing, and says so kindly.
- Sits at the bar for a quick in and out.
- Away at tournaments now and then; comes back with results and stories.

Voice. Warm, quick, sincere. "Hey, buddy!", "Gotta be quick today!", "You good?". When hurt: quieter and more formal.

Favourite dish	Big Breakfast Plate
Favourite drink	Gator Goo
Seating	Bar
In town	Comes and goes (tournaments)

Pairs	Makayla
Special fields	`grudge`

How your choices land. Warm is his favourite. Playful works too. Rude puts that chef on his `grudge` list: he stays a bit cold to them on every visit, and his next ordering conversation offers them an apology option (see Special).

Dialogue

Arrival

- First visit ever: "Hey! I'm Seth! Sorry, I've only got twenty minutes, I've got a game. What's your name? [name]! Awesome. Okay, I'll remember that. I always remember."
- "Hey, buddy! Gotta be quick today. Game at six!"
- "[name]! What's up! Bar seat? Perfect. In and out."
- Football day: "Football today. I'm gonna run so much. I need fuel."
- Baseball day: "Baseball today! I'm pitching. Nervous. Excited. Mostly excited."
- Volleyball day: "Volleyball later. Iddy's on the other team. I'm gonna go easy on him. I'm not gonna go easy on him."
- Back from a tournament: "I'm back! We came second! Second's great! It's not first. But it's great!"
- Last meal was great: "Your breakfast last time? Best game I've ever played. Coincidence? No."
- Last meal was burnt: "Last time was a little burnt, buddy. All good. I still scored."
- With a grudge: "Hey." (No "buddy." He doesn't look at that chef.)

Ordering conversation A

Seth: "Big Breakfast, please! Fast as you can! No pressure! Some pressure."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I'll have it out in record time. Good luck at your game."	"You're the best, buddy! I'm gonna win this one for you."	+0.05

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Playful	"I'll cook it while you warm up. Stretch at the bar."	He actually starts stretching. "Okay! Hamstrings!"	+0.05
Straight	"One Big Breakfast."	"Thanks, [name]!"	0
Rude	"Then go somewhere faster."	His tail stops. "...Okay." (Grudge.)	-0.05

Ordering conversation B (intuition)

Seth: "Hey. You okay? You seem a bit off today."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"Long day. Thanks for noticing."	"I always notice. Take a breather after this, okay? Big Breakfast, please."	+0.05
Playful	"How do you DO that?"	"It's a gift! And a curse. Mostly a gift."	+0.05
Straight	"I'm fine. What can I get you?"	"Okay. If you say so. Big Breakfast." He doesn't quite believe you.	0
Rude	"Stay out of my business."	Quietly: "Sorry. Just checking." (Grudge.)	-0.05

Ordering conversation C (the apology, only with a grudge)

Seth, flatly: "Big Breakfast. Thanks."

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm (apology)	"Seth, about what I said last time. I'm sorry. I didn't mean it."	Long pause. His tail starts wagging slowly. "...Thanks for saying that. Really. We're good, buddy." (Grudge cleared.)	+0.05
Playful	"Cheer up! It's game day!"	"Yeah." He's still cold.	0
Straight	"One Big Breakfast."	"Thanks."	0
Rude	"Still sulking?"	"I remember what you said. "[last_rude_line]"." He doesn't say anything else.	-0.05

Drink order

- Favourite: "Gator Goo! Hydrate or die-drate!"
- Gator Goo not unlocked yet: "No Gator Goo? Water, then. Lots of water. All the water."
- Other: "Anything with electrolytes!"

Serving

- Perfect: "BUDDY. That's a championship breakfast. I'm unstoppable now."
- Great: "Yes! Perfect fuel. Thanks, [name]!"
- Okay: "Thanks! I'll eat it on the way!"
- Burnt: "Little crispy! All good, I need the carbs!"

Eating chats

- He's eating very fast. "Mmf. Sorry. Game. Mmf."
- "Makayla says she can beat me at anything. She's right about most things. Not darts."
- "Rush is always late and I'm always early. We should average out."
- "I could tell something good happened before I walked in. Did something good happen?"
- "My coach says I need to eat more protein. I told him about this breakfast. He's coming next week."

Eating chat with choices

Seth: "Can I tell you something? Mabel's been a bit quiet lately. I can tell. Can you check on her?" (Changes to whichever regular is lowest right now.)

Tone	You say	He says	Mood
Warm	"I will. Thanks for looking out for her."	"Of course. That's what friends do. Even friends of friends."	+0.05
Playful	"Are you a retriever or a detective?"	"Both! Retriever-detective. Retrective."	+0.05
Straight	"Okay. I'll keep an eye out."	"Thanks, buddy."	0
Rude	"Not my problem."	"...Okay." (Grudge.)	-0.05

Special: intuition

Once Seth has been served by a chef 3 or more times without a grudge, he starts reading the room. One line per visit, picked by what's actually going on:

- Yesterday had unhappy customers: "Rough day yesterday? You seem tired. You're doing great, buddy."
- A regular is at a negative stage: "[regular] seems down. Maybe make their favourite next time?"
- The serving streak is high: "You're on a roll today, I can feel it!"
- A new star was just earned: "Something big happened. I can tell. You look proud. You should be."
- Nothing special: "You seem good today. Good. I like that."

Special: never forgets

Picking rude with Seth adds that chef to his `grudge` list. From then on, with that chef only: no "buddy", shorter lines, and he looks away. His next ordering conversation with that chef is the apology version (C). Apologising clears the grudge for good. There's no mood penalty from the grudge itself; it's just how he treats that chef until things are made right.

Leaving

- "Gotta go! Game time! Thanks, [name]!" He's out the door before the bill's even printed. (He's already left the money.)
- "Wish me luck! Or don't, I'm gonna win anyway! Kidding! Wish me luck!"
- Leaving for a tournament: "Tournament this week! I'll be gone a few days. Don't miss me too much!"
- With a grudge: "Bye."

Seasons and holidays

- Spring: "Baseball season! Best season!"
- Summer: "Beach volleyball! Every weekend! I'm so tan. Under the fur. You can't see it."
- Autumn: "Football season! Also the best season!"
- Winter: "Indoor volleyball. Still the best season. They're all the best season."
- Halloween: "I'm a referee!" Makayla is also a referee. They didn't plan it.
- Christmas: "I got you a sweatband! For the kitchen! Makayla had the same idea. Now you have two."

With friends

- With Makayla: Seth: "Race you to finish." Makayla: "Okay." She's done before he picks up his fork. Flat: "That was so fun."
- With Makayla: "I always know when Makayla's happy, even though her face doesn't move. Right now? She's thrilled." Makayla: "...No." (She is.)
- With Chompy (both love football and Gator Goo): "Chompy watches every game. He doesn't know the rules. He's my biggest fan."
- You've been kind to Makayla: "Makayla said you were nice to her. She said it flat, but she meant it. I could tell."
- You've been rude to Makayla: "Makayla told me you said "[last_rude_line]". She covered her eyes for a whole minute. Not cool, buddy."